



CAPTAIN SMIT SPEAKS TO PM

‘Used every bit of energy to save lives’

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A clearer, more workable framework for future treaty negotiations

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CALL FOR CHANGE

Pargat Singh appointed Punjab Congress chief

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IN BRIEF



SP to field a third candidate in Raja Sabha election

LUCKNOW
The Samajwadi Party (SP) on Friday said it will field a third candidate in the Raja Sabha election, setting the stage for a contest for all 10 seats that will go to the polls on October 16. The SP has already nominated senior leader Ram Gopal Yadav and industrialist Dhanraj Nathwani. » [Page 4](#)

Names of 28 places in Ladakh standardised

NEW DELHI
The Government of India, in consultation with the Union Territory administration of Ladakh, has identified 28 places and geographical features in the region by standardised names on the official Survey of India map. » [Page 10](#)

Youth, leaders detained amid protest against CEC

Opposition parties, activists, and student groups protest across various States seeking Gyanesh Kumar's resignation; hundreds detained in Delhi; Rahul Gandhi condemns the police action

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Opposition parties, civil society activists, youth and student organisations held protests across the country on Friday demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

In Mumbai, the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP)-led protests at Shivaji Park received support from actors and artists. In Delhi, the police detained over 500 people, including former Chief Minister Atishi.

The Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, condemned the police action against the protesters and said hundreds are in custody. “Their only crime is that they dared to question vote theft,” he said.



Protest against CEC Gyanesh Kumar near Jantar Mantar, in New Delhi, on Friday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Thousands joined the protests on Gandhi Jayanti, demanding Mr. Kumar's resignation. “Bapu taught us exactly this – speak the truth, fight peacefully. And that's what scares this government the most. A lathi can stop a crowd, but not a question. Gyanesh Kumar will go. And the system

that put him there will go too,” Mr. Gandhi said.

CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke announced that if Mr. Kumar does not resign, “cockroaches from across India” will protest at Jantar Mantar on October 10. All India Students' Association national president Neha Bora has called for a fresh

EC asks States to enrol voters left out in SIR

NEW DELHI
The Election Commission has directed States and Union Territories where the special intensive revision (SIR) has been completed or is under way to identify eligible voters left out of the current rolls and facilitate their enrolment within a month. » [PAGE 9](#)

protest at 1 p.m. on Saturday, saying, “Jantar Mantar 2.0 is not done! It has just begun.”

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Trade deal with India is not ‘imminent’, says U.S. Trade Representative after talks

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

While negotiations on an India-United States trade deal are nearing the end, the deal itself is not “imminent”, U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer indicated on Friday. His comments followed a “constructive conversation” with Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal in the U.S. on the sidelines of the G20 Trade Ministerial conference.

“We had a very constructive conversation, Minister Goyal and myself,” Mr. Greer said at a press conference. “Our staff is meeting right now, since they are in the country and we are here. We are continually trying to finish the trade deal with India.”

“I would characterise it, as we say in the U.S., we're in the short strokes,” he added. “So I think we're toward

the end of it. At the same time, I don't think there's something imminent.”

‘Universe of items’
Mr. Greer said that the two sides had identified the “universe of items” that are sticking points for both sides and are “working diligently” to address them. He added that U.S. President Donald Trump and Prime Minister Narendra Modi had a “constructive call” on Wednesday, and said that there may be another call between the two leaders “very soon” to assess progress on the deal.

The India-U.S. trade deal has been heavily delayed ever since it was announced by Mr. Modi and Mr. Trump in February 2025 due to various tariff actions taken by the U.S. since then.

The larger Bilateral

Trade Agreement (BTA) was supposed to have been concluded by “Fall 2025” (October-November 2025). Subsequently, talks on a “mini deal” addressing only tariffs also failed to fructify.

Feb. joint statement
In February 2026, the two leaders once again issued a joint statement committing to finalising an interim agreement on trade and continuing negotiating the BTA.

The interim agreement was to have been finalised by March-April 2026. Neither the interim deal nor the BTA has so far been finalised. On India's part, Mr. Goyal has been vocal in saying that India will not sign a deal until it is made clear that it will receive a comparative advantage over its competitors, as was agreed to in February 2026.

Indore water deaths probe report was doctored to protect BJP leaders: Cong.

Mehul Malpani
BHOPAL

The Congress on Friday alleged that the one-man judicial commission report on the Indore water contamination tragedy was “manipulated to protect” Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) leaders, including Mayor Pushyamitra Bhargava and Bhagirathpura councillor Kamal Baghela, by “putting pressure” on the Justice Sushil Kumar Gupta (retd.) panel.

The panel noted that the tragedy was preventable and held guilty the then IMC Additional Commissioner (Water Supply) Rohit Sisonia and then Executive Engineer (Water Supply) Sanjeev Shrivastava among other Indore Municipal Corporation (IMC) officials while clearing to two former civic body commissioners.

Addressing a press conference in Indore, Leader of the Opposition (LoP) in the Madhya Pradesh Assembly Umang Singh said the water quality in India's cleanest city had fallen to the level of “small villages in Africa”, and sought a first information report against those responsible for the tragedy that claimed more than 30 lives between December 2025 and February 2026.

“This is the 21st century but even quality drinking water is not being made available. The situation in Indore, which is an economically emerging city, is today similar to that in Africa's small villages. The IMC has an annual budget of ₹8,500 crore,” he said. He also accused the BJP of failing to provide clean drinking water. Citing an IMC report, Mr. Singh said many areas and various go-

vernment hospitals in Indore were still receiving water contaminated with bacteria such as E. coli even eight months after the tragedy.

‘No accountability’
Mr. Singh accused the BJP government of failing to fix accountability, despite the probe report blaming the tragedy on institutional failure due to several long delays that go up to 859 days in replacing or repairing the damaged water pipeline in Bhagirathpura, the hot spot of the tragedy.

“I can say with accountability that even this report has been manipulated. The government put pressure on the retired judge to put blame on two officials and ‘save our councillor, Mayor and Minister [and local MLA Kailash Vijayvargiya],” alleged the LoP.

Glittering display



Reaping it rich: The Indian women's hockey team regained the gold medal after 44 years and sealed a berth for 2028 Los Angeles Olympics. India also won three gold in boxing and one each in archery and wrestling at the Asian Games on Friday. R.V. MOORTHY (REPORT ON PAGE 15)

CCTVs in 2% parks; several categorised as high-risk: DDA

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Only 16 of the Delhi Development Authority's (DDA) 736 parks, or 2.2%, have CCTV cameras, according to an internal safety audit report, the urban body stated in a release on Friday. The audit flagged safety concerns across the parks and classified them by risk, with 190 categorised as high-risk.

The audit was completed within a week following directions from Lieutenant-Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu after the alleged gang rape of a 17-year-old girl in Astha Kunj Park, which triggered protests in the national capital.

FULL STORY ON
» [PAGE 2](#)

New EC portal options let EROs in Delhi clear voters without documents, hearings

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

New options have been introduced on the Election Commission's ECINET portal allowing Electoral Registration Officers (EROs) in Delhi to mark an elector as eligible without requiring documents or a hearing to dispose of a notice issued against the elector's name, officials told *The Hindu* on Friday.

The change comes amid allegations of “centralisation” of the functioning of ECINET, which is being used by poll officials for the special intensive revision

of electoral rolls in several States.

Sources said a new dialogue box, which now lets EROs clear voters for the final roll without scheduling a hearing or seeking documents, was not available before September 30. While clearing an elector, the ERO is required to upload a declaration that they are satisfied with the voter's eligibility and have completed the verification.

EROs exercise the final authority over the preparation of the roll and decide on all claims and objections. Officials across constituencies said the options

should have been made available from the beginning of the notice phase on August 31.

“The option to bypass hearings on a case-by-case basis should have been available to us from the start. We should have been allowed to take calls in cases where none of the prescribed documents is available,” said an ERO.

Another ERO said, “I first saw the options on Wednesday. So now if I am satisfied with cases where electors don't have prescribed documents, I can submit a declaration that I have completed verification

and proceed. I have disposed of hundreds of cases a day since then.” He could not clear more than 50 cases a day earlier.

‘Nov. 30 deadline’
According to latest data, proceedings have been concluded in fewer than 5 lakh of the 33.1 lakh cases in which notices were generated. In one West Delhi constituency, only two cases have been cleared so far.

The last date for the disposal of notices is November 30.

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» [PAGE 8](#)

Buxa Reserve regains its stripes with the release of a three-year-old tigress

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

A three-year-old tigress, T138, was released into the Buxa Tiger Reserve in West Bengal on Friday, marking the beginning of a phased programme to reintroduce tigers and establish a viable, self-sustaining population in the reserve.

The tigress was translocated from Bihar's Valmiki Tiger Reserve and released in the presence of Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav and West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari. Mr. Adhikari said three more tig-



New home: The tigress was brought from Valmiki Tiger Reserve, marking the beginning of a phased programme. X/BYADAVBJP

ers would be released in Buxa in the next two months, and the initiative would not only help in conservation of wildlife but also in boosting tourism in the region. “Inspired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi's push for landscape

conservation and species protection, today we have fulfilled the significant promise to reintroduce a tiger in Buxa,” Mr. Yadav posted on social media.

Buxa was declared a Tiger Reserve in 1983. “Over the decades, however,

habitat degradation and fragmentation, changes in land use and decline in prey availability have affected the ecological conditions required to sustain a resident tiger population. The Reserve subsequently witnessed a prolonged absence of a stable resident tiger population,” a press statement by the PIB said.

Senior forest officials said T138 would be subject to intensive post-release monitoring using a combination of telemetry, camera trapping and field-based monitoring to assess her movement, adaptation, health and behaviour.

Poll officials named ‘objectors’ in 25 cases; ‘reason’ column left blank in draft roll

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

Electoral Registration Officers (EROs) and Assistant Electoral Registration Officers (AEROs) were named as ‘objectors’ for 25 voters among thousands of objections filed against electors in Delhi’s draft roll, according to an analysis of Form 10 reports – a public list of all objections to the inclusion of names in electoral rolls – between September 21 and 27.

These were the only entries among the 1,997 electors whose names were objected to using Form 7 during the seven-day pe-

riod in which the ‘reason’ column was left blank.

The 25 include 12 objections in Sadar Bazar, three of them by EROs; seven in Malviya Nagar; four in Chhattarpur; and one each in Kirari and Vikaspuri.

All 25 electors had been flagged for notices for either a ‘logical discrepancy’ or ‘no mapping’ in the draft roll published on August 31. Former Election Commissioner Ashok Lavasa said while the practice of EROs and AEROs filing Form 7s was “unheard of”, using the form to initiate an inquiry could be a “technical requirement” and would not in itself be



Voters who received notices during the ongoing special intensive revision queue with documents in Delhi. FILE PHOTO

“illegal” if followed up by due process.

The cases form part of the 4,401 objections received during the claims and objections phase of the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) drive.

Response of officials

When reached for comment on why they had filed the objections, the EROs and AEROs concerned cit-

ed reasons such as deaths, field-verification reports by Booth Level Officers (BLOs), complaints from relatives and cases where electors did not appear for notice hearings.

Mala Sood, an ERO from Sadar Bazar, said, “This is merely an objection, which could be due to various reasons, including the voter’s death or based on BLO reports. No deletion will happen without verification. A mandatory notice is generated and sent again to the elector.”

Officials in Malviya Nagar said the objections were raised against the names of ‘ineligible’ vo-

ters. “This was done based on a BLO field report, according to which the elector was not at their registered address when the BLO visited to deliver the SIR notice,” an official said.

Form 7 is used to seek deletion of an existing name or to object to the inclusion of a name on grounds such as death, duplicate enrolment, non-citizenship, absence or having permanently shifted. The onus of proof is on the objector, who must be an elector in the constituency.

What rules say

While the Election Commission’s (EC) Manual on

Electoral Rolls 2023 and intensive revision guidelines are silent on whether an ERO and an AERO can raise objections through Form 7s, EROs are empowered to initiate an inquiry based on BLO reports to examine whether a name should be deleted.

The deletion must follow an inquiry, and a reason must be cited for the action. An ERO exercises final authority over the preparation of the roll and decides on all claims and objections.

The *Hindu* sent queries to Delhi Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) Ashok Kumar’s office on whether EROs

and AEROs are expected to use Form 7 to initiate *suo motu* inquiry. No response was received till the time of going to press.

‘Could be formality’

“If the official concerned has followed it up [filing of Form 7] up with an inquiry, he could be fulfilling a technical formality. Although I am not sure whether the technical formality was required,” said Mr. Lavasa.

The deadline for filing claims and objections is October 30 while the final electoral roll is scheduled to be published on December 4.

Man killed, son injured in Jwalapuri house collapse

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

A 50-year-old man died while his 20-year-old son was injured after their ground-plus-one-storey house collapsed in outer Delhi’s Jwalapuri area, an official said on Friday.

The Delhi Fire Services (DFS) official said the incident took place around 4 p.m. on Thursday near Udyog Nagar metro station. The house, spread over around 25 square yards, collapsed, trapping the father and son under the debris.

A DFS team rescued the two and rushed them to Sanjay Gandhi Hospital, where the father, Samsuhal, was declared dead, while his son, Soheb, was admitted with a back injury, the official said.

Only 2% DDA parks have CCTVs; several flagged ‘high-risk’, over 100 require gunmen: audit report

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Only 16 of the Delhi Development Authority’s (DDA) 736 parks, or 2.2%, have CCTV cameras, according to an internal safety audit report, the civic body said in a press release on Friday. The audit flagged safety concerns across the parks and classified them by risk, with 190 categorised as high-risk, 258 as medium-risk and 288 as low-risk. It also identified 134 parks that require gunmen

According to the release, the audit was completed within a week following directions from Lieutenant-Governor Tarunjit Singh Sandhu after the alleged gang rape of a 17-year-old girl in Astha Kunj Park, which triggered



190 parks have been classified as high-risk, 258 medium-risk and 288 low-risk. FILE PHOTO

protests in Delhi and was followed by a police encounter in the area.

Lighting concerns

Lighting emerged as one of the main concerns, with the audit identifying 520 parks that require additional illumination. The DDA said work was being taken up on priority in some of these parks, while night patrolling had begun

in 245 major parks and bike patrols had been started in all high-risk parks.

The authority has also identified 323 parks for installation of CCTV cameras. According to officials, security measures were being strengthened at park entrances, with 163 parks requiring gates to be made lockable. Boundary walls and missing grills have also been taken up for repair in several parks.

“Biometric attendance for security guards is active in 602 parks,” the release stated. The authority said it was preparing standard operating procedures covering patrolling, guard performance, attendance and incident reporting and coordination with the police. A dashboard has also been set up to track the safety measures.

Blocked routes and repeated detentions mark SIR protest

Protesters fan out across central Delhi from multiple points in an attempt to reach Jantar Mantar; AISA president Neha among those who jumped off police buses; NSUI chief questions restrictions

Ashna Butani
Shrimansi Kaushik
NEW DELHI

Students and activists attempting to march to Jantar Mantar were detained at multiple points in central Delhi on Friday as the police barricaded most roads leading to the protest site. Several protesters who managed to get out of police buses were detained again as they tried to continue the demonstration.

The protest, called on Gandhi Jayanti by several student and youth organisations, political leaders and activists, was against alleged irregularities in the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. The protesters sought the resignation and arrest of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. The organisations that gave the call included the All India Students’ Association (AISA), Students’ Federation of India (SFI) and Democratic Youth Federation of India (DYFI).

With routes to Jantar Mantar blocked, AISA members set out from the Vice-President’s Enclave, while SFI and DYFI members began their march from Mandi House. Mem-



Held back: Protesters being detained in a police bus while trying to reach Jantar Mantar on Friday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

bers of Congress-backed National Students’ Union of India (NSUI) marched from Raisina Road.

AISA president Neha Bora, activist Yogendra Yadav and other protesters approaching Jantar Mantar from Patel Chowk were stopped at Samrat Ashok Chowk. At least four women Delhi police personnel in pink vests without name tags pulled Ms. Bora towards a bus as several Central Armed Police Forces personnel stood around them. The protesters were then driven away.

Addressing protesters who marched towards Jantar Mantar, NSUI president Vinod Jakhar questioned the restrictions on the

protest.

“Why are the government and the Election Commission afraid of questions? If the electoral process is transparent, then answer the questions before the people. Instead of putting up barricades and detaining students, the authorities should address the concerns being raised about voters and their democratic rights,” he said.

Detained repeatedly

Near Shangri-La on Ashoka Road, AISA members formed a human chain in front of the bus, allowing Ms. Bora and a few protesters to jump out and return to the demonstration site. They sat on the road and

raised slogans against Mr. Kumar and called to “end the dictatorship of [Prime Minister] Modi” before being surrounded by security personnel and taken back to the buses. Ms. Bora subsequently managed to get out of the bus once more and was detained again.

Akshat Shikhar, a Delhi University student associated with AISA, criticised the requirement for police permission to hold the protest. “The fact that we need permission from the police to protest is fundamentally flawed. They are violating our rights the way they are striking names off the rolls,” he said.

Mudita of the Krantikari Yuva Sangathan, who was among a group of women students looking for a place to protest without being detained, said, “It is being treated like a terrorist site. First, you don’t give us the right to vote. Then, you don’t give us the right to protest against it. If everything is going to be dictated, we may as well call it a dictatorship.”

Anand Prakash, who had come to Delhi from Bareilly to visit a family member, said he had decided to go to Jantar Mantar to see the protest but could not reach the site.

‘Missing badges, force used’: protesters allege police excesses at stir

Shrimansi Kaushik
NEW DELHI

Protesters at the Jantar Mantar site on Friday alleged police excesses, including a detained man being punched by a police officer, women police personnel not wearing name tags and a female protester being detained and taken away in a bus with other activists, allegedly without any women police personnel present. Several Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) leaders also alleged that police presence at or near their homes prevented them from reaching the site.

Missing badges

Several women personnel were seen detaining female protesters without wearing name tags. When asked, they turned away without responding.

A female protester said she was detained and taken on a bus along with other activists around 6 p.m. “They started asking for our names, addresses and phone numbers. A woman police officer came only after an hour when I complained. We were re-



(Above) A policeman is seen punching a detainee in a police van; women personnel seen without name tags. X/ANI

leased around 8.30 p.m.” she said. AISA activists also accused police of using force against protesters, including women.

Neha Yadav, DCP, Perception Management and Media Cell, denied the allegations of manhandling.

Earlier in the day, AAP MP Sanjay Singh wrote on X that he was stopped near Rashtrapati Bhavan and prevented from going to Jantar Mantar. Delhi AAP unit chief Saurabh Bhargava said the Station House Officer of his area had been at his home since the previous night.

‘Scrap SIR’: disgruntled voters take part in stir, demand accountability

Suruchi Kumari
Ashna Butani
NEW DELHI

Voters whose names were deleted from the electoral roll, left out of the draft roll or flagged for discrepancies were among hundreds who took to the streets in the Capital on Friday to protest the special intensive revision (SIR), demanding that the exercise be scrapped and accountability fixed. For many voters unable to reach the heavily barricaded Jantar Mantar protest site, the protest was about having to prove their eligibility to vote repeatedly.

Among them was Shabana Mallik from Mustafabad, who said she had completed her enumeration form but was now being asked to submit another document because of a name mismatch. She said she was taking part in the protest for her children’s right to vote. “If I don’t speak up now, how will I know my children are exercising their voting rights fairly?” she said.

Shaleja Hussain, 38, from Shahadatpura, said



she had submitted her enumeration form but found her name missing from the draft roll. She had to file Form 6. “I had been voting for so many years. Is there no value to it?” she said.

Amit Sharma, a civil engineer from Yamuna Vihar, said his name was deleted in 2024 and he had been trying to get it restored since then.

Subodh Kumar from Chhattarpur said, “My name got omitted around three months ago. Since then, I’ve tried three or four times to fill the forms. I have even complained to the Election Commission.”

He added, “I am here today is that I want [CEC] Gyanesh Kumar to resign because our voting rights have been stolen.”

THE HINDU GROUP

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Organisational matters should be resolved within Cong.: Venugopal

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

All India Congress Committee (AICC) general secretary K.C. Venugopal on Friday refused to be drawn into the controversy over the latest differences within the Congress in Kerala, aired openly by United Democratic Front (UDF) convener Adoor Prakash on Thursday.

Responding to media queries at Mr. Prakash, Mr. Venugopal said organisational matters and differences of opinion between leaders should be discussed and resolved within the party rather than in public.

His remarks came amid



AICC general secretary K.C. Venugopal in Kollam on Friday. Sports Minister O.J. Janeesh is also seen. C. SURESHKUMAR

media speculation about the internal crisis brewing within the ruling UDF, with Mr. Prakash choosing to openly criticise Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan's manner of functioning and his "unilateral" decision-making on various counts

without consulting within the UDF or Congress leaders.

Mr. Venugopal also took exception to the manner in which "some quarters" chose to link him personally with every political controversy and personal

views expressed by Congress leaders. "Why is my name being dragged into everything? Are you people not done making Venugopal the accused in every controversy?" he said.

His comments seemed to be in response to the speculation that Mr. Prakash's criticism and comments against Mr. Satheesan had his backing.

Mr. Venugopal also announced a nationwide "Vote Bachao, Desh Bachao" campaign from October 2 to 8, in coordination with major political parties and leaders of the INDIA bloc, to protest against the threats to democracy and people's right to vote.

Over 23,700 Form-7s received in Karnataka after claims period

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Even after the claims and objections period got over, at least 23,770 Form-7 applications seeking deletion of names from electoral rolls were received between September 24, a day after the claims and objections period ended, and October 1, data from the office of the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO), Karnataka, show.

This revelation comes a day after Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar and his Cabinet colleagues staged an over-five-hour protest at the Karnataka CEO's office and made the CEO relent, ordering legal action over false claims in bulk Form-7 applications filed across

the State. In Bhalki, Babalshwar, Belagavi North, Kodagu and several other constituencies, pre-filled Form-7 applications were filed in bulk, mostly targeting Muslim voters.

40% increase

The number of Form-7 applications received between June 16, when the electoral rolls were frozen ahead of the special intensive revision (SIR), and September 24 stood at 61,130. As of October 1, the number had increased to 84,990, a rise of about 40%.

Applications filed after the claims and objections period will be considered only after the SIR process, while those filed up to September 23 will be consi-

dered for the final electoral rolls, scheduled to be published on October 27. In a press release on Friday, however, the CEO's office said, "Out of the 84,900 Form-7 received, the number of forms received for objection to proposed inclusion is nil."

The Hindu had reported that bulk filing continued even after the objections period ended in constituencies such as Bhalki in Bidar district. The statutory Form-10 report shows that 1,131 applications were received in Bhalki between September 24 and 29, of which 1,123 were bulk filings. When asked about the figures on applications, CEO V. Anbu Kumar maintained that they were "as per the dashboard data".

Gandak water enters new areas of Saran

Press Trust of India
PATNA

Floodwater from Gandak river on Friday entered new areas of Saran district following the breach of embankments as Bihar grapples with flood.

Gandak, Ganga, Kosi, Bagmati and Ghagra rivers are flowing above the danger mark at several locations after heavy rain in Nepal and Uttar Pradesh, officials said. Gandak has put embankments in many districts at risk.

Timings
DELHI

SATURDAY, OCT. 03			
RISE	06:15	SET	18:05
RISE	23:27	SET	13:09
SUNDAY, OCT. 04			
RISE	06:15	SET	18:04
RISE	00:00	SET	14:02
MONDAY, OCT. 05			
RISE	06:16	SET	18:03
RISE	00:35	SET	14:47

Delhi Weather	max	min
Delhi City	36	23
Safdarjang	36	23
Palam	34	22

Delhi Palam Today
35°C Morning will be pleasant with mist and haze. The weather will be dry. Day will be warm with uneasy afternoon. Night also will be pleasant.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow
36°C The weather will be dry. Day will be very warm with uneasy afternoon. Night will be pleasant.

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Vishvendra Singh quits Cong.; party says no intimation yet

The Hindu Bureau
JAIPUR

Shortly after former Minister Vishvendra Singh announced on social media that he would quit the Congress, the party leadership in Rajasthan on Friday sought to downplay the issue and said no formal resignation has been received. The Congress said Mr. Singh continues to be a

party member.

"A social media post cannot be considered as submission of resignation," Pradesh Congress Committee president Govind Singh Dotasra told journalists here. He also accused the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party of engineering the rift, saying the allegations against the leadership formed part of the "BJP's toolkit".

Mr. Singh had launched a sharp attack on Mr. Dotasra and questioned the State Congress's organisational structure and ticket distribution after the recent urban local body elections.

In a social media post on Friday, Mr. Singh said his public life was spotless and he would find it "better to die a death of dignity than to suffocate".

Gujarat's UCC Bill gets President's assent

Press Trust of India
AHMEDABAD

The Gujarat Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Bill, 2026, has received the assent of President Droupadi Murmu, paving the way for its implementation, a notification published in the Gujarat government gazette has informed.

The Act will come into force on a date to be decided by the State government through a notification in the gazette. The legisla-

tion, passed by the Assembly in March 24, was published in the extraordinary gazette dated October 1. The notification said the Act received the President's assent on September 17.

The Act seeks to "govern and regulate the laws relating to marriage and divorce, succession, live-in relationship and matters related thereto" and extends to the whole of Gujarat, also applying to residents of Gujarat living

outside the State.

The Act, however, specifically excludes members of Scheduled Tribes covered under Article 342 of the Constitution and persons or groups whose customary rights are protected under Part XXI of the Constitution.

The legislation, which provides a common framework for marriage, divorce and succession, besides regulating live-in relationships, prohibits bigamy. It also allows marriages to be

solemnised according to customary practices, religious beliefs, ceremonies, rites and rituals, and specifically lists practices.

Registration of marriages is mandatory, with parties having to submit a memorandum for registration within 60 days for marriages solemnised after the commencement of the code. The Act provides for a penalty of up to ₹10,000 for wilfully failing to submit a mandatory registration memorandum.

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For kind attention of general public, allottees and stakeholders of the real estate project "One Global" situated at sector - 73 Village Begampur Khatoia Dist. Gurugram being developed by promoter namely M/s Capital Heights Pvt Ltd.

1. This is to inform the general public, allottees, stakeholders, and concerned authorities that the promoter of the project Namely "ONE GLOBAL" has applied for change of the bank accounts.
2. The above-mentioned project is registered with the HARERA Gurugram vide registration no. 30 of 2023 dated 02.02.2023 and the registration is valid up to 30.09.2026.
3. Existing Bank Account and New Bank Account Details are as follow:

Particulars	Account No.	Bank Name	Branch Address	IFSC
Master Account	1548953896	Kotak Mahindra Bank Ltd.	S-214, Ground Floor, Panchsheel Park, New Delhi - 110017	KKBK0004611
RERA Account	1548953919	Kotak Mahindra Bank Ltd.	S-214, Ground Floor, Panchsheel Park, New Delhi - 110017	KKBK0004611
Free Account	1548879561	Kotak Mahindra Bank Ltd.	G-1 & G-2, ATM -1, Vipul Plaza, Sun City, Sector - 54, Gurgaon, Haryana - 122002	KKBK0004265

4. The promoter has submitted a request for change of the designated bank accounts before the Authority, which is presently under consideration.
5. This notice is being issued for information purposes only to the general public, allottees, and stakeholders in respect of the above-mentioned project.

Sd/-
Secretary
For Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority, Gurugram

Dated: 03.10.2026

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NOTICE

Applications are invited from the eligible Company/Individual, as per SOP, intending to have 'Short Term Settlement' grant in his/his favour of any Tea Garden(s), which were abandoned / closed and/or are being operated by virtue of bipartite agreements in terms of the State Government Notification No. 3955-LP/3T-03/24 dated 06.11.2024 published in the Kolkata Gazette on November 11, 2024.

For details, please visit www.labour.wb.gov.in.

Chairman,
Tea Garden Short Term Settlement Committee
and
Labour Commissioner, West Bengal
Labour Department

ICA- N 267(6)/2026



JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice Rule No. 712/191

Dy. SP HQ, Jammu has intimated that during investigation of cases (1) FIR No. 08/1980 and (2) FIR No. 202/2009 U/S 307/323/325/341 RPC of P/S Nowabad the involvement of one suspected person namely Harjeet Singh S/O Gur Bachan Singh R/O Rai Singh Nagar Rajasthan has been surfaced. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name : Harjeet Singh
S/O : Gur Bachan Singh
Address : Rai Singh Nagar Rajasthan

Contacts/Telphone Numbers:-

1. DPO, Jammu	: 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D	: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu	: 0191-2605949
4. SP City South	: 0191-2433778
5. Dy. SP Hqrs.	: 0191-2562259
6. SHO P/S Nowabad	: 0191-2565274

Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu

DIP/J-11547/26 Oct 1 2026



JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
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Hue and Cry Notice Rule No. 712/191

Dy. SP HQ, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Ramesh S/O Kalish R/O Bihar A/P Rajinder Nagar, Jammu is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 140/2001 U/S 293/109 RPC, of P/S Nowabad, Jammu, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name : Ramesh
S/O : Kalish
Address : Bihar A/P Rajinder Nagar, Jammu

Contacts/Telphone Numbers:-

1. DPO, Jammu	: 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D	: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu	: 0191-2605949
4. SP City South	: 0191-2433778
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for MDS in Govt./ Private Dental colleges of Bihar

Advt. No.- BCECEB(PGDAC)-2026/05 Dated : 02.10.2026

Notice for Round-3 Online Application & Choice Filling

Online Registration & Submission of Application-cum-Choice filling after Round-2 are invited from such qualified, eligible & interested NEET(MDS)-2026 candidates for appearing in the Round-3 Online Counselling of Under Post Graduate Dental Admission Counselling (PGDAC)-2026, who have not done the Registration and submission of Online Application or who has completed their registration process but did not duly submit Online Application with payment of requisite Counselling Fee & Security Deposit against Adv. No. BCECEB(PGDAC)-2026/01 & 2026/02 Dated 18.08.2026 and 2026/03 Dated 14.09.2026 and are not admitted in any Dental Colleges of India, for admission to the first year PG Dental Courses (MDS) in Government / Private Dental Colleges in Bihar based on the Rank of PGDAC-2026 prepared on the basis of AIR of NEET(MDS)-2026 on the basis of vacant seats available after admission on the basis of PGDAC-2026 Online Round-2 Counselling held from 29.09.2026 to 30.09.2026.

2. Updated Seat Matrix of vacancies after completion of Round-2 Counselling is available on Board's website: bceceboard.bihar.gov.in . If any further vacancies due to resignation etc. arise, the Updated Seat Matrix will be uploaded on the Board's website. The candidate must see it before Online Registration & Submission of Application-cum-Choice filling / submitting their Consent / editing of choices for Online Counselling.

3. The online Registration & submission of Application-cum-Choice Filling / Editing of Application Form data / Editing of Choices will start from **05.10.2026** .

4. Eligibility criteria for Online Counselling, Fee payment procedure, Choice filling, instructions and other details are available in the Prospectus of PGDAC-2026 and the related detailed Advertisement No. BCECEB(PGDAC)-2026/04 Dated 02.10.2026 which can be downloaded from the Board's website: bceceboard.bihar.gov.in.

Controller of Examination

INBRIEF



Sharad Pawar begins tour of drought-hit Maharashtra areas

Nationalist Congress Party (SP) chief Sharad Pawar on Friday began a tour of Maharashtra's drought-affected regions, assuring farmers that he would take up their woes regarding crop losses and severe water shortages with the State government. The former Union Agriculture Minister interacted with villagers in Purandar tehsil of Pune district to assess crop damage and water scarcity. Mr. Pawar had written to Mr. Fadnavis earlier this week, pointing out that although the State government had declared drought in 265 of Maharashtra's 358 talukas, several other regions were also facing severe water scarcity and crop losses. PTI

40 fall ill after consuming 'contaminated' flour in U.P.

At least 35 women and five children fell ill after consuming suspected contaminated finger millet (ragi) flour ahead of the Jitiya fast in Uttar Pradesh's Ballia district on Friday, a health official said. The incident took place in Chhata village under the Bansdih Road police station area, where the women consumed the flour as part of preparations for the festival. Chief Medical Superintendent Dr S K Yadav said the affected women were admitted to the district hospital, with around 20 currently undergoing treatment there. "Our team is active and there is no need to worry," he told reporters. PTI

CM Vijay launches expanded no-fare bus travel for women; to benefit 84 lakh beneficiaries

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay launched the 'Vettri Payanam' scheme on Friday, expanding the no-fare bus travel for women and transgender persons, at the Koyambedu bus terminus in Chennai. Coinciding with Gandhi Jayanthi, Mr. Vijay kickstarted the scheme by issuing free tickets to women passengers.

The scheme will benefit 84.32 lakh beneficiaries every day. It is an expansion of the five-year-old 'Magalir Vidiyal Payanam' scheme. Under the expanded scheme, women can make no-fare travel in the ordinary, express, limited stop service (LSS), and deluxe buses in cities and towns, ordinary buses in the mofussil areas, and ordinary buses in the ghat sections beyond 40 km.



T.N. Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay issuing tickets to passengers while launching 'Vettri Payanam' scheme. X/CMOTAMILNADU

S. Malar, a resident of Chennai who was in one of the buses at Koyambedu, said, "It was pretty surreal and exciting to see the Chief Minister issue tickets to passengers." K. Abhirami, a resident of Tiruvallur, was glad the scheme was being expanded. "I had the opportunity to even take a photograph with him [Mr. Vijay]," she said.

A total of 12,695 buses under the seven State Transport Corporations have been brought under 'Vettri Payanam'.

Poll code curbs

The scheme will not be implemented in Chengalpattu and Tiruppur districts as the model code has been in place there for the Assembly election.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Amid criticism over Hindi signage found on a Highways signboard, the Tamil Nadu government on Friday said it had suspended the Assistant Executive Engineer and the Assistant Engineer responsible for the "unauthorised Hindi inscriptions" on the Nagercoil-Madurai State Highway (SH-93), pending further action. Departmental action had been initiated against them.

An official press release said the Hindi inscriptions on the signboard along the newly inaugurated road on the State Highway in Satankulam had been removed. The State government will take appropriate action against officials who act contrary to the State's two-language policy, the release added. Earlier in the day, DMK

The government said it will take action against officials who act contrary to the two-language policy

president M.K. Stalin condemned the use of Hindi signage.

In a post on X, he said, "Until now, Tamil Nadu was facing Hindi imposition by the Union government. Now, the State government itself is doing it."

Public Works Department Minister Aadhav Arjuna said: "The two-language policy is a vital principle for the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam, too. Two officials responsible for this lapse were suspended yesterday (October 1). Moreover, the signboard written in three languages was replaced immediately with a new one written in two languages."

Nagaon LS bypoll: dried fish follows biryani in campaign

Rahul Karmakar
GUWAHATI

Sun- or smoke-dried fish is a delicacy in Assam. It can also be divisive at times, used for body-shaming or as a classist or racist slur against certain food cultures.

In the electoral battle for the Nagaon Lok Sabha seat, dried fish has followed biryani and biscuits to target candidates and key campaigners.

The by-election to the Muslim-dominated constituency is scheduled for October 6. Pradyut Bordoloi won the seat for the second successive term in 2024, but quit Congress to contest and win the Dispur Assembly constituency as a Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) candidate in April 2026, necessitating the bypoll.



Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma and Congress leader Rakibul Hussain are targeting each other through the plate. FILE PHOTO

During one of his campaigns, All India United Democratic Front (AIUDF) chief Mohammed Badruddin Ajmal referred to Congress MP Rakibul Hussain as a "madman". He also said the MP was "born eating dried fish, not biryani", a veiled reference that he is more Bengali than Assamese.

Although dried fish is popular among some indigenous communities, it is



associated more with Bengalis — Hindus and Muslims — in Assam. Bengali speakers are a sizeable population in Nagaon.

A former State Minister, Mr. Hussain is a Nagaon native and a Congress key campaigner. He ended Mr. Ajmal's winning streak in western Assam's Dhubri Lok Sabha seat by more than 10 lakh votes.

The food narrative entered the Nagaon bypoll

campaign on September 28 when Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma recalled his association with Mr. Hussain during his Congress days. During one of his campaigns, the Chief Minister also commented on the latter's food habits.

Mr. Hussain countered by saying God made him wealthy enough to eat biryani, while referring to Mr. Sarma's alleged weakness for biscuits.

"What can I do if he (the Chief Minister) was born to eat biscuits in the morning and at night? He got to see pulao and chicken after joining Congress," Mr. Hussain said.

The Chief Minister reacted by comparing the Congress MP to Bakasura, a mythological crane-demon with an insatiable appetite. He also said the MP consumes pulao and meat

three times before 9 a.m.

"Does an infant drink its mother's milk or eat biryani after birth? Those in the former category are humans, and those in the latter are beasts," Mr. Sarma said while campaigning in the Muslim-majority Juria area.

Former Cong. bastion

The Nagaon Lok Sabha constituency was a Congress bastion before Rajen Gohain won it for the BJP four times from 1999 to 2014. Congress wrested it in 2019 and 2024. The BJP has fielded former bureaucrat Devassish Sharma in the constituency. His prime rivals are former MLA Sibamoni Bora of Congress and Mr Ajmal of the AIUDF.

The constituency has 12 other contestants, including nine independents.

SP to field third candidate for Rajya Sabha, setting up stage for fight in all seats

Will take route BJP took in 2024 RS poll, says Oppn. party MP referring to ruling party's move to field extra candidate, force contest; SP backs dynasties, capitalists but seeks PDA votes: Mayawati

Press Trust of India
LUCKNOW

Hinting at a possible patch-up with those who had left the party, Samajwadi Party (SP) president Akhilesh Yadav on Friday said the Rajya Sabha election is the "time to come together" and to "stand united with others on matters of principle".

His remarks assume significance in the context of comments made by SP Lok Sabha member Virendra Singh hours earlier — that the party will field a third candidate in the Rajya Sabha poll, setting the stage for a contest for all 10 seats that will go to the polls on October 16.

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)-led National Democratic Alliance (NDA), which has 288 MLAs in the 403-strong Assembly, is poised to secure seven seats. The SP, which has 101 MLAs and is expecting support from the Congress which has two legislators, can secure two.



Rajya Sabha election is the 'time to come together', SP president Akhilesh Yadav said at an event in Lucknow on Friday. FILE PHOTO

A tight contest is expected for the 10th seat, as the BJP is expected to have a surplus of 31 or 32 votes and the SP about 29 votes. The SP has so far nominated two candidates — senior leader Ram Gopal Yadav and industrialist Dhanraj Nathwani.

Rajya Sabha elections are based on proportional representation and single transferable vote, which ensures that the surplus votes of winners are transferred to remaining candidates according to their second preferences.

Thus, if more than 10

candidates enter the fray, the outcome will boil down to technicalities and astute planning, party leaders on both sides said.

'BJP MLAs to jump ship'

Earlier in the day, Mr. Singh, the party's Lok Sabha member from Chandauli, claimed several ruling party MLAs want to contest the 2027 U.P. Assembly election on SP tickets and are in touch with his party.

On the Rajya Sabha poll, he said, "We will get all three of our candidates elected through the same route that the BJP had ta-

ken last time." He was referring to the 2024 Rajya Sabha poll, in which the BJP had fielded an eighth candidate despite having the numbers to get seven elected unopposed, forcing a contest that it eventually won amid claims of cross-voting.

'Double standard'

Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP) chief Mayawati accused the SP of practising "dynastic politics and favouring wealthy industrialists" while seeking support from the 'PDA', which is Mr. Yadav's coinage for 'Pichhde' (backward classes), Dalits and 'Alpsankhyak' (minorities).

"Public opinion suggests that the SP's third candidate will likely be a face-saving measure and a losing candidate," she said, adding that while Mr. Yadav's party seeks votes from the PDA, it "mostly elects its own family members and big capitalists as MPs and MLAs".

(With inputs from Mayank Kumar)



BJD chief Naveen Patnaik at launch of the party's 'Jan Sampark Padayatra' in Bhubaneswar on Friday. SPECIAL ARRANGMENT

Majhi govt. epitome of mismanagement, inefficiency: Naveen

Satyasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR

Former Odisha Chief Minister and Biju Janata Dal (BJD) chief Naveen Patnaik on Friday lashed out at Mohan Charan Majhi-led BJP government, saying it was the epitome of mismanagement and inefficiency. "This government couldn't even properly manage a single Rath Yatra. Mismanagement in flood relief, mismanagement in paddy procurement, mismanagement in recruitment examinations, mismanagement in financial management. This government has failed in every task. People are saying that perhaps the Odisha BJP government has acquired special expertise in mismanagement," he said.

The BJD on Friday launched 'Jan Sampark Pa-

dayatra', its annual month-long public outreach programme on occasion of the birth anniversary of Mahatma Gandhi. Addressing the launch of public outreach programme, Mr. Patnaik said Odisha is currently passing through a difficult period.

'No responsibility'

"The Central government has taken away the rights of Odisha's residents over mines, and the Odisha government is silent, 20 BJP MPs are silent. But they are ready to fight for mine owners. It is good not to talk about textbooks for children. Thousands of mistakes. But this government is reluctant to take responsibility," Mr. Patnaik said.

The BJD chief said no work is getting done yet the debt burden is increasing.

Seven students among 9 held for violence on Lovely varsity campus

Press Trust of India
CHANDIGARH

Nine persons including seven students have been apprehended in connection with the violence on the Lovely Professional University (LPU) campus, police said on Friday.

DIG Jalandhar Range Naveen Singla told reporters on Friday that two FIRs were registered in connection with the incidents of arson, loot, rioting, infrastructure damage, police vehicles being torched, unprovoked attack on police force and blockade of the national highway. "In both these FIRs based on CCTV footage, technical analysis, media posts, social media posts and other corroborative evidence, we have carried out nine arrests so far," the DIG said.

In another incident in which students of Chitkara University in Patiala district

had held a protest a week ago and also damaged a police vehicle over unverified claims that two female students were found dead on the campus, Patiala police on Friday said they have arrested two persons for spreading rumours on social media and other platforms leading to the incident.

In the incident involving LPU University in Phagwara, Mr. Singla said four were apprehended from Phagwara, two were rounded up from Jammu and Kashmir while two were apprehended from Mumbai.

Massive protest

LPU students had held a massive protest on Sunday and also blocked a stretch of the New Delhi-Amritsar Highway outside their campus over claims that an outsider had raped a female student on the university premises.

Sena leader's murder: two key suspects arrested

Press Trust of India
THANE

The police on Friday arrested two key suspects, including the shooter, allegedly involved in gunning down of Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Pradeep Purnekar in Maharashtra's Thane city, police said.

Acting on technical surveillance, police nabbed shooter Nikhil Yadav and Nitesh Pawar near Pen in Raigad district in an early morning operation, securing critical leads about the Ghodbunder Road shooting, an officer said.

The fatal shooting on Tuesday night triggered tensions as hundreds of Sena (UBT) workers, alongside family members and leaders Aaditya Thackeray and Sanjay Raut, gathered outside Kapurbawdi police station, carrying Purnekar's mortal remains post-autopsy on Wednesday.

Mayawati's nephew Akash seeks another chance after expulsion

Press Trust of India
LUCKNOW

A month after being expelled from the Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP), Akash Anand on Friday dismissed rumours that he would join another outfit and appealed to his aunt Mayawati for "an opportunity" to serve the party again.

In a post on X in Hindi, Mr. Anand referred to Ms. Mayawati as 'buaa maa' and described her as his political guru and inspiration.

This was Mr. Anand's first public reaction after BSP supremo removed him as the party's national coordinator and then relieved him from the party on September 10.

His remarks came after several senior leaders indi-



Akash Anand

cated that Mr. Anand could join their parties if he wanted to.

Many offers

Nishad Party chief and Uttar Pradesh Fisheries Minister Sanjay Nishad publicly offered Mr. Anand a place in his party. Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav also indicated that the party's doors were open to him.

Union Minister and RPI chief Ramdas Athawale also invited Mr. Anand to join

his outfit.

"Whatever I have learned in politics, I learned from you. Whatever I have done, I did under your guidance. Therefore, today I wish to place my words directly before you and before the entire Bahujan society. For the past few days, various kinds of news and rumours about me have been circulating in the media and social media. I want to clarify: I am not going to any other political party. The BSP is not just a party for me; it is my family," he said.

He added that he supports Ms. Mayawati's decision to expel his father-in-law, Ashok Siddharth, and sought an apology, explaining that his past silence was misunderstood.



Another pre-printed Form 7
surfaces, fuels apprehensions

Multiple Indian payloads sent to orbit by Space X's Falcon 9

Real estate firm promoter held in ₹927-cr. fraud case

He was arrested on September 30 under Section 19 of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002, based on multiple FIRs filed at various police stations in Bengaluru.

Rainy ride: Motorists make their way through a sudden spell of rain in Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh, on Friday. K.V.S. GIRI



Obstacle race

The Special Intensive Revision exercise is threatening universal adult franchise

On Gandhi’s birth anniversary, many Opposition parties, student groups and other citizens took to the streets in Delhi, Mumbai and elsewhere demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar. Their grievance was that Mr. Kumar has presided over a Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise meant to “clean” the electoral rolls, but in practice has become an exercise in the serial disenfranchisement of lakhs of Indian citizens. The BJP-led Union and State governments reacted predictably, refusing permission for the protest and imposing prohibitory orders. In Delhi, the government shut down the Internet in the Jantar Mantar area, closed 11 Metro stations and detained over 700 protesters. In Mumbai, the police denied permission for the gathering at Shivaji Park, but the protesters turned up anyway. The reason for the anger is plain. Emboldened by a deferential Supreme Court verdict upholding the SIR’s constitutional validity, the Election Commission of India (ECI) has taken the flawed method that it first adopted in Bihar, added a new exclusion criterion called “logical discrepancies” that it first implemented in West Bengal, and extended it from State to Union Territory (UT). The enumeration process puts the onus on electors to prove their eligibility, with many deleted first and verified later. Getting back onto the rolls after being struck off the draft is onerous, while dubious mass requests for deletion are easy to file and quick to process. Nearly 13.4 crore electors have been removed from the draft rolls across 30 States and UTs – about 14% of the electorate before the revision. Each phase has deleted more than the last: 8.3% in Bihar, 12.9% across the 12 States and UTs of Phase 2, and 17% in Phase 3.

The ECI has said that deleted electors can return during the claims phase, but only as fresh applicants provided they find that they have been struck off. The ECI’s own members objected to the plainly illegal changes to procedure. Form 6 was altered without any amendment to the rules, asking applicants whether they, or their parents or grandparents, appeared on the roll of the last SIR. In West Bengal, 16.1 lakh requests were filed to remove electors whom judicial officers had already cleared. A centralised roll database in New Delhi helped make this possible. The ECI has now asked BLOs to restore deleted voters to the rolls; it is an implicit admission that the process disenfranchised many. The semi-corrective steps do not absolve the two Election Commissioners. As majority in the ECI, Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi could have overruled the CEC. The exercise, as it is being carried out now, is an obstacle not only to universal adult franchise but also to electoral democracy itself.

Rescue act

Preventing ecological degradation is the way to protect wildlife

The first tiger to be reintroduced in West Bengal represents a triumph of bureaucracy, not ecology. After the National Tiger Conservation Authority found no tigers in the Buxa, Dampa, and Palamau reserves by 2018, it mooted a programme with the Bengal Forest Department and the Wildlife Institute of India that has culminated with a royal Bengal tigress caught in Bihar to be released in Buxa. She is the first of seven to be relocated over two years. Buxa is dotted with settlements and surrounded by revenue villages and tea estates. The region already hosts an elephant population routinely threatened by a railway line, with the railways also planning to restore a route to Jainti. Commercial traffic on the Bhutan-West Bengal road through Buxa is another problem. Estates are also notorious for fragmenting the landscape, including migration corridors. The area’s forests have turned into dense woodland with a closed canopy, stifling the growth of grasses and causing herbivore populations to dwindle. The density of chitals, tigers’ prey, is dismal; goats, macaques and cattle have become more common in tiger diets in place of their preferred ungulates. Since 2018, the collaboration has reintroduced chitals; artificially opened some canopies to help revive grasslands; and relocated villagers from the reserve’s core to mitigate human-wildlife conflicts. This last measure is, however, also a window into the cynical character of the reintroduction programme.

From 1973, India followed preventive conservation practices that protected source populations and their habitats, and maintained prey bases and corridors. Buxa, however, belongs to a more recent, more reactive tradition that also includes Sariska and Panna, where authorities intervened only after tiger populations crashed. A reintroduction programme showcases technical capabilities but is also more expensive and heavy-handed, and reflects Project Tiger’s problematic belief that the core habitat needs to be inviolate – one the state machinery has used to override the rights of Adivasis and forest-dwelling communities and disrupt incomes from ecotourism. The reserve is also part of an international wildlife corridor contiguous with Phibsoo in Bhutan, to the north, and Manas in Assam to the east. If these forests offer higher prey density or fewer disturbances, the tigers may disperse. Success at Buxa means introduced tigers establish territories and produce cubs, which survive and breed, with natural immigration maintaining genetic diversity. But success should also be an advance, rather than a rescue, and entails monitoring ecological deterioration such that the state does not wait for tigers to vanish to act and involving communities in and around Buxa in decisions about preventing conflicts and protecting livelihoods.

On September 23, a two-judge Bench of the Supreme Court of India, comprising Justices Dipankar Datta and Satish Chandra Sharma, delivered a split verdict on a set of petitions which assailed the validity of the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023. Remarkably, the judges were divided not on the merits of the challenge, but on whether a Bench of two was competent to decide the matter at all.

An appointment framework

The statute, which was enacted in December 2023, provides that the Chief Election Commissioner and the Election Commissioners shall be appointed on the recommendation of a selection committee comprising the Prime Minister, the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, and a Union Cabinet Minister nominated by the Prime Minister. This law replaced an interim arrangement that a Constitution Bench of five judges had put in place in *Anoop Baranwal vs Union of India* (2023). Under that arrangement, the Chief Justice of India (CJI) sat as the third member in place of a Minister.

Midway through the hearings in the matter, which began in May, the Union government changed tack and argued that the case raised a substantial question of law as to the interpretation of the Constitution. It therefore claimed that the challenge, in terms of Article 145(3), ought to be heard by a Bench of at least five judges. Curiously, this plea was made even though it found no place in the Union’s counter-affidavit.

While Justice Datta rejected the request, Justice Sharma accepted it. Ordinarily, a difference of opinion on a Bench of two is resolved by a Bench of three. But reasoning that a ruling on which of their opinions was correct would only delay matters further, both judges jointly placed the papers before the CJI asking him to consider constituting a Constitution Bench. The upshot is this: the petitioners, who came to court in early 2024, must now wait again.

As Justice Datta rightly held, Article 145(3) merely prescribes that a case involving a substantial question of constitutional interpretation ought to be decided by a Bench comprising a minimum of five judges. It does not ask whether a case is important or whether a statute under challenge is new. As far back as in 1959, in *State of Jammu and Kashmir vs Thakur Ganga Singh*, the Court explained, albeit in a different context, what a question of constitutional interpretation entails. “The question of interpretation can arise only if two or more possible constructions are sought to be



Suhrit Parthasarathy

Advocate practising in the Madras High Court

The Court needs structural reform to strengthen constitutional adjudication and consistency

placed on a provision – one party suggesting one construction and the other a different one,” the Court had held. “But where the parties agree on the true interpretation of a provision or do not raise any question in respect thereof, it is not possible to hold that the case involves any question of law as to the interpretation of the Constitution.” A Bench of three judges later applied the same reasoning to Article 145(3) itself, in *People’s Union for Civil Liberties vs Union of India* (2003).

A deeper institutional fault

What, then, did *Anoop Baranwal* settle? Justices Datta and Sharma agreed that the committee the judgment had created was a stopgap, meant to last only until Parliament enacted a law. To that extent, the Union may well be right in claiming that the CJI’s place on the committee is by no means constitutionally entrenched. But the Constitution Bench also read Article 324 to require that appointments to the Election Commission be insulated from exclusive executive control. This was a clear declaration of law, binding on every court under Article 141. As Justice Datta held, whether a committee in which the executive holds two votes out of three meets that standard is merely a question of applying this settled rule to a new statute.

Justice Sharma’s opinion adopted a different test. He held that since “there is no authoritative decision of this Court till date pronouncing upon the constitutional validity of the [2023] Act, the matter must be heard by a Constitution Bench of not less than five Judges.” But almost any challenge to a fresh statute would, in this sense, be the first of its kind. On such logic, Benches of two judges could not have decided *Shreya Singhal vs Union of India* (2015), which struck down Section 66A of the Information Technology Act or *NALSA vs Union of India* (2014), which affirmed the right of transgender persons to their self-identified gender. Each called for a searching analysis of the Constitution and its guarantees.

Ultimately, though, a disagreement of this kind points to a deeper fault in the Court’s architecture.

When the Court first sat, in January 1950, it had six judges (a sanctioned strength of eight judges). Article 145(3), with its minimum of five, assumed that the Court would, in the main, sit together to interpret the Constitution. Today the Court has a sanctioned strength of 38 judges. It functions largely in panels of two and spends most of its time on special leave petitions. A Constitution Bench is assembled only when the CJI can spare at least five judges from this daily churn. The result, as the scholar Nick Robinson has argued, is not one court but many, with each Bench speaking in its own voice.

India’s Model BIT — a decade later, amid changes



Ivoti Singh
Advocate based in Delhi and has been a legal consultant to the Department of Economic Affairs, Government of India

negotiations, while leaving sufficient room for necessary adjustments in individual agreements. It is here that the contributions of Makane Moïse Mbengue are relevant. His scholarship teaches that a developing state need not always be a rule-taker under international investment law, but can also be a rule-shaper through its treaty practice. India’s revamp of its Model BIT offers a similar opportunity.

The international context has also changed. The United Nations Trade and Development (UNCTAD) points to a shift toward investment facilitation, cooperation, sustainable development and more carefully defined investor protections, with less reliance on traditional investor-state dispute settlement (ISDS). The United Nations Commission on International Trade Law (UNCITRAL) is examining reforms to the ISDS, including a permanent tribunal and appellate mechanism, damages and compensation, and dispute prevention. India’s revised Model BIT must therefore respond to a changing investment regime, not merely revisit the 2015 Model.

What a new model must factor in

The new model must consider whether to include the Most Favoured Nation (MFN) provision. In most investment treaties entered into by India, the MFN provision is absent, reducing the possibility for an investor to claim better protection under other treaties. However, if the new model includes this provision, it should be very clear about its scope. In *Emilio Agustín Maffezini vs Kingdom of Spain*, an MFN clause was used to bypass an 18-month local-court requirement by relying on more favourable dispute-settlement provisions in another treaty. *Plama Consortium Limited vs Republic of Bulgaria* rejected the importation of such provisions in the absence of a clear treaty provision. Recent treaty drafting also provides examples of expressly excluding dispute-settlement procedures from the scope of MFN clauses. The scope of the MFN provision should therefore be defined, particularly in relation to dispute settlement.

Investor obligations are another aspect of recent Indian practice that can help set a foundation for the new model. Under the India-Uzbekistan BIT, a state is expressly permitted to assert a counterclaim against an investor or investment. The new model can take a cue from this practice and lay down investor obligations and the circumstances in which counterclaims can be asserted.

The provision on dispute settlement also calls for reassessment. The five-year requirement to exhaust all judicial and administrative remedies under the 2015 Model could be assessed against the practices adopted by India since then. The three-year period for pursuing local remedies used in the India-UAE and India-Israel investment agreements shows greater flexibility in India’s approach. The Model BIT may also provide for more effective consultation and dispute-prevention procedures prior to arbitration, which are being discussed at UNCITRAL Working Group III.

Need for precision, clarity

The substantive protections should be equally precise. Clarity of language concerning expropriation and fair and equitable treatment (FET) could help avoid confusion in interpretation while safeguarding the right of the state to regulate for the public good. Sustainable development and responsible investment must not be left as policy declarations. Where India wishes to impose obligations on investors, those obligations should be expressed in clear legal terms. The changes need not make the new model uniformly more favourable either to investors or to states. The aim should be a model that is clearer, more workable and better suited to India’s position today, while allowing room for necessary adjustments in individual treaties.

With the revised model now reportedly finalised and awaiting Cabinet approval, the key question will be whether its final text adequately reflects the lessons of India’s treaty experience over the past decade while providing a coherent framework for future negotiations.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Service extensions

We have recently witnessed a trend of granting routine service extensions to senior bureaucrats, particularly State Chief Secretaries, Union Secretaries and other officials, beyond their superannuation, leaving aside officials of parastatal bodies. While governments often cite “administrative

exigencies” and the need for continuity, the long-term institutional costs can outweigh the short-term benefits, particularly when no compelling administrative necessity exists. As constitutional heads have pointed out in public forums, extending the tenure of retiring officers can demoralise the

administrative system and create an artificial bottleneck at the top, limiting the career progression of capable officers next in line. Keeping a select few officials in key positions for extended periods can also blur the line between professional administration and political alignment. There must be

merit-based succession. Alternatively, if experience and continued public service are considered essential, the retirement age could be raised to 62. **Sanjoy Das Sarma,** Kolkata
Making dissent visible
The sparse media coverage of the CJP protests on

October 2 raises a larger question about what the media chooses to make visible. The media must recognise that it is dealing with a Gen Z already showing signs of deep disillusionment with institutions and politics. When an important section of this generation takes to the streets, ignoring or

underplaying it does not make the issue disappear. It can instead reinforce the perception that both the media and the government are indifferent to their concerns. **R. Narayanan,** Navi Mumbai
Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

GROUND ZERO

Deleted, and left in limbo

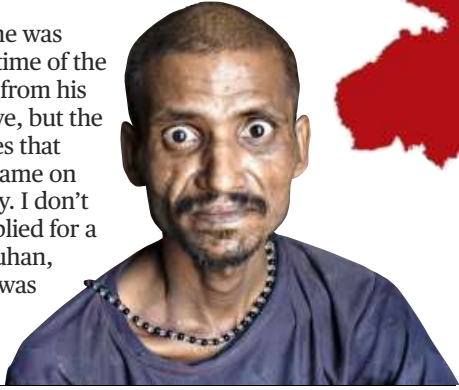
Across Bihar and West Bengal, lakhs of voters were deleted from the electoral rolls during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise, leaving them unable to vote in the 2025 and 2026 Assembly elections. Over 47 lakh names were deleted in Bihar and nearly 91 lakh in West Bengal. **Shrabana Chatterjee** and **Senjuti Sengupta** met some of those affected, documenting the uncertainty, paperwork, and repeated attempts to prove their citizenship and eligibility that followed the deletions

Deepak Chauhan

35; Ziradei constituency, Siwan district, Bihar; currently unemployed

Reason for deletion: Absent

Chauhan, who is disabled, says he has no idea why he was deleted from the list. He says he was at home at the time of the the exercise and the booth-level officer (BLO) is also from his village. “The BLO knows that I live here and I am alive, but the BLO still marked me absent,” he says. Chauhan hopes that local volunteers and activists will be able to get his name on the list. “I live in a lot of pain because of my disability. I don’t know how to get my name back on the list. I had applied for a new [voter ID] card, but did not get it,” he says. Chauhan, who has never missed voting in an election, says he was unable to vote in the 2025 Bihar Assembly elections. He last voted in the 2024 Lok Sabha polls.



Sunil Sah

36; Ziradei constituency, Siwan district, Bihar; Border Security Force personnel

Reason for deletion: Already registered

Sah’s father says his son was not present during the SIR process to fill up the form. His family filled up the form, yet Sah’s name was struck off the list. “He is a government servant. He is serving the nation. And yet his vote has been taken away,” says Sah’s father. He adds that local activists are helping them fill up Form 6, so that Sah can be registered as a new voter. Sah did not come back from duty to vote in the 2025 elections because his name was deleted, says his father. “Otherwise, he always tries to come back to exercise his democratic right to vote,” he says.



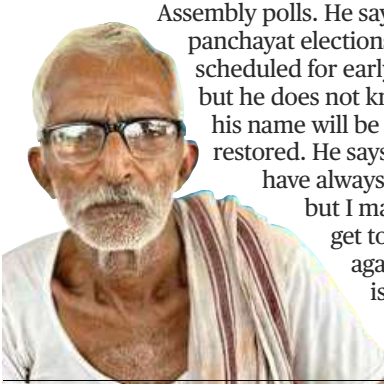
Ramashankar Sah

70; Ziradei constituency, Siwan district, Bihar; farmer

Reason for deletion: Already registered

Sah says he has never voted anywhere except in his own constituency. “The cause of deletion is ‘already registered’. Why did they remove my name? I don’t understand,” he says. He also says he had submitted all the documents. He has asked local officials for help, but no one has been able to give him an answer. Local activists are now helping him. Sah was unable to vote in the 2025 Bihar

Assembly polls. He says the panchayat elections are scheduled for early 2027, but he does not know if his name will be restored. He says: “I have always voted, but I may not get to vote again. How is that okay?”

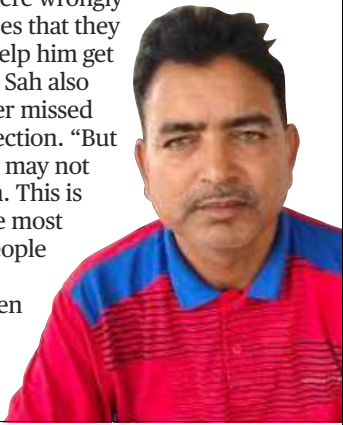


Shri Bhagwan Sah

52; Ziradei constituency, Siwan district, Bihar; farmer

Reason for deletion: Already registered

Sah says he has only one voter ID. “This feels like a targeted attack. My whole family was deleted for the same reason,” he says. Sah says only local political workers from the Communist Party of India (Marxist-Leninist) Liberation are helping the family by conducting surveys to find out whose names were wrongly deleted. He hopes that they will be able to help him get back on the list. Sah also says he has never missed voting in any election. “But now I fear that I may not get to vote again. This is ‘vote chori’. The most marginalised people – SCs, STs, and OBCs – have been impacted by this,” he says.

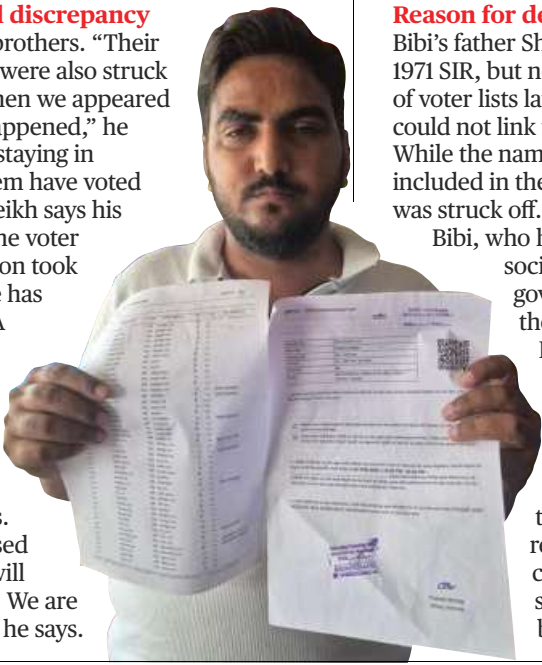


Md. Alauddin Sheikh

47; Samserganj constituency, Murshidabad district, West Bengal; local politician who also contested in 2021

Reason for deletion: Logical discrepancy

Sheikh says he is one of three brothers. “Their names and their wives’ names were also struck off. We told the officers that when we appeared for the hearing. But nothing happened,” he says. Sheikh’s family has been staying in Samserganj for years. All of them have voted regularly over the decades. Sheikh says his great grandfather featured in the voter list of 1952 when the first election took place in independent India. He has appealed before the tribunal. A member of the Social Democratic Party of India in Murshidabad, he believes that the deletion is politically motivated. “The ruling government is excluding all the Muslim voters. Their intention has been exposed through this exercise. But we will resist them. We are not scared. We are all are Indian no matter what,” he says.



Hazera Bibi

33; Rejinagar constituency, Murshidabad district, West Bengal; bidi worker

Reason for deletion: Unmapped

Bibi’s father Sheikh Haider Ali’s name was listed both in the 1995 and 1971 SIR, but not in the 2002 SIR. His name was included in revisions of voter lists later as a new voter. Therefore, Bibi and her siblings could not link their names with any relatives from the 2002 SIR list. While the names of her three siblings have been included in the latest SIR despite this gap, Bibi’s name was struck off. She has appealed before the tribunal.

Bibi, who had been availing herself of several social welfare schemes run by the State government, is no longer able to access them. Her benefits under the National Food Security Act have also been suspended. “I’ve been voting since 2019. Now the government seems to believe that I am not even a resident of this country and has snatched away my benefits,” she says.



Durgabati Devi

47; Ziradei constituency, Siwan district, Bihar; homemaker

Reason for deletion: Already registered

Devi says she had filled up all the forms that the BLO had provided. “I submitted the documents, I did everything that was asked of me. Yet they deleted my name without any reason,” she says. Devi has asked the local officials why her name was deleted and what she should do to get it restored, but again, no one has answers. She is unsure of whether she will ever be able to get back on the electoral rolls. Since her name is absent, Devi says she could not vote in 2025. “For a poor person like me, exercising my franchise is the only power I have in this country. That power has been taken away from me,” she says.



Md. Mojahar Hossain

39; Samserganj constituency, Murshidabad district, West Bengal; school teacher who also served as a BLO during the SIR

Reason for deletion: Logical discrepancy

Six other people claimed Hossain’s father as their own in the 2002 SIR list. Hossain says he doesn’t have six siblings. “I have one sister and three brothers. The reason (for deletion) is terribly funny,” he says. While the names of his three brothers were included in the latest SIR, his sister’s and father’s names were also excluded. The Election Commission told his father, Liakat Hossain, that his name did not match the 2002 SIR list. Later, they found that his surname was misspelled as Liakat ‘Hosen’ in that list although the EPIC number was the same. Hossain has appealed before the tribunal. Three other teachers from his school, who served as BLOs like him, have also been excluded in the SIR this time. “I have surveyed over 1,000 voters in my booth. I had filled up my form with my own hand. Who would have thought that I would be one of those 300 people whose names would be excluded. I don’t know what is going to happen next,” he says.



S.K. Riaz

24; Medinipur constituency, Paschim Medinipur district, West Bengal; student

Reason for deletion: Logical discrepancy

Riaz says there was a discrepancy in his father’s name and that, because he had provided his father’s name to establish his link to the 2002 rolls during the mapping and form-filling process, his own name was also struck off. He says their cases were sent to the tribunal and are still under adjudication. “We have not heard back from officials on getting our names restored,” he says. Since every family member’s name was struck off the list, he says the family is not getting their rations. “We have gone to the officials at least six times and filled up multiple forms. Now we get some basic rations, but not the actual quantity we are entitled to. This feels like a targeted attack,” he says.



Rakesh Chauhan

36; Ziradei constituency, Siwan district, Bihar; labourer

Reason for deletion: Already registered

Chauhan says he had two voter cards because officials filled in the wrong details. This, he says, is what has led to him being included under the ‘already registered’ category. Now both the cards are invalid. “I have no idea how to get my name back on the rolls,” he says. “I have spoken to local gram panchayat leaders and officials. But I could not vote in 2025. I have two voter cards and not a single vote.” It is because of the officials’ mistake and not his that his voter rights have been taken away, he insists. “How is that okay when the fault was not even mine? This is such a mess,” he says.



Faruk Kazi

19; Rejinagar constituency, Murshidabad district, West Bengal; labourer

Reason for deletion: Logical discrepancy

Kazi’s parents’ names were not listed in the 2002 SIR as they had registered themselves as voters much later. During the survey, Kazi linked his name with his grandfather Hossain Ali whose name was on the 2002 list. All his family members found themselves back in the final voter list in the 2026 SIR, except Kazi. He has appealed before the tribunal. “I was excited to vote for the first time. My parents’ names and elder brother’s names were included in the SIR. I have no idea why my name was struck off,” says Kazi, who registered himself as a new voter only in 2025 and was supposed to cast his first vote in the 2026 Assembly elections. As no decision has been taken yet by the judicial officer in the tribunal, he will also not be able to vote in the upcoming by-poll on October 6.

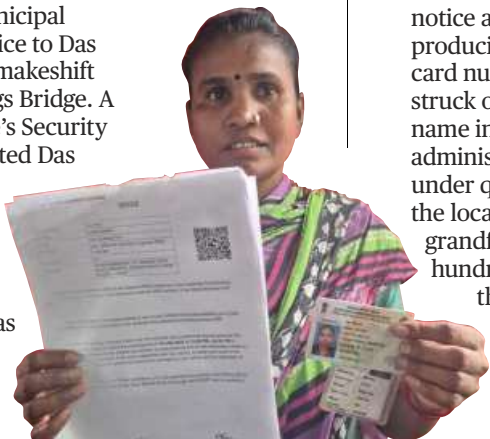


Rati Das

35; Kolkata, West Bengal; Kolkata Port constituency; ragpicker

Reason for deletion: Unmapped

Das is a first-generation voter in her family. Her father died when she was a child. After his death, her mother was driven out by her in-laws. Along with her two children, she occupied a pavement under Hastings Bridge in Khidirpur. Das does not have a permanent house. In 2012, she and her sister got themselves registered as voters and also started exercising their franchise in every election. But now both their names have been struck off as they failed to link themselves with any of their relatives on the 2002 list. Das has appealed before the tribunal. After the deletion, the Kolkata Municipal Corporation issued a notice to Das asking her to vacate her makeshift settlement under Hastings Bridge. A team from Kolkata Police’s Security Control Organisation visited Das and her sister last month and checked all their documents. “They asked me whether I came from Bangladesh. How will I prove that I was born and brought up in this city? Could you tell them that I am Indian?”



Md Shamim Akhtar

49; Entally constituency, Kolkata, West Bengal; Wing Commander (Retd), Indian Air Force

Reason for deletion: Unknown

Akhtar says he was not placed under any category. He says his name and his father’s name were both there in the 2002 voter list. He submitted all the documents, yet in February this year, his name came under adjudication, he says. “When the supplementary lists came out in March 2026, I saw that my name had been deleted. They did not even let me appear for a hearing or give me notice about how to solve the problem. I was struck off without any procedure,” he says. Akhtar worries that the BLO has stopped taking his calls. Neither he nor the BLO has any idea how to get his name restored, he says. “This is a complete violation of a person’s democratic right,” Akhtar adds. “Every person responsible for this should be tried for stripping us of our basic democratic right as a citizen of this country.”



Najmatara Khatoon

29; Samserganj constituency, Murshidabad district, West Bengal; Anganwadi worker

Reason for deletion: Logical discrepancy

The name of Khatoon’s father, Abdul Haq, was listed as Abdul Haq Sheikh in the 2002 SIR. Due to the mismatch, she was issued a notice and asked to appear for a hearing. Despite producing all the documents, including her father’s EPIC card number that matched the 2002 list, her name was struck off. She appealed before the tribunal to have her name included. “When I approached the local district administration officers, they said my nationality is under question,” she says. “I have been serving in the local Anganwadi for years. My great grandfather built our home over a hundred years ago. How dare they say that I am not Indian?”



Photo credits: Shrabana Chatterjee and Senjuti Sengupta. Emails: shrabana.chatterjee@thehindu.co.in; senjuti.sengupta@thehindu.co.in

Imamuddin Sheikh

53; Rejinagar constituency, Murshidabad district, West Bengal; elected member of Rampara (II) Panchayat in Rejinagar

Reason for deletion: Logical discrepancy

Sheikh’s father Wahab Sheikh’s name was listed as Kalu Sheikh in the 2002 SIR. However, his other documents, including the EPIC card, show him as Wahab Sheikh. “Kalu is my father’s nickname. He often writes it as Wahab Sheikh (Kalu). But the previous SIR list only registered him as Kalu Sheikh. Despite him providing his EPIC card number, which is the same in the SIR list, the Election Commission did not approve it and removed my name,” says Sheikh. He has appealed before the tribunal to get his name restored. Meanwhile, he worries that he will no longer get various government benefits. “I contested in the 2023 panchayat election and won the Rampara (II) seat. But I will not be able to contest in the next election if my name is not restored. My father passed away. But the rest of my family members got their names included in the SIR,” says Sheikh who has voted in several elections since 2005.



From Page One

Youth and leaders detained amid protests

Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal said members of the Opposition parties are ready to go to jail to save democracy.

The Democratic Youth Federation of India (DYFI) national president and CPI(M) MP A. A. Rahim, who was detained at Jantar Mantar, said the authorities denied permission for peaceful protests even at the designated protest site. “They have blocked Jantar Mantar, closed down the Metro stations and shut down the Internet....Senior leaders like Brinda Karat and M.A. Baby were detained. But they cannot stop our protests. We will continue our resistance till Mr. Kumar tenders his resignation,” Mr. Rahim said.

The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) said the crackdown has raised a fundamental question about the right of citizens to protest peacefully over concerns about their votes. Senior AAP leader Manish Sisodia said in a post on X, “The protest is against Gyanesh Kumar, and Amit Shah is engaged in crushing this protest. Today, the Delhi Police is determined to suppress every voice demanding Gyanesh Kumar’s resignation.”

New Delhi turned into a fortress owing to heavy police deployment and barricading at Jantar Mantar, restricting the entry of people trying to protest. The Students’ Federation of India and DYFI had issued a call for the protest to begin from Mandi House. The National Students’ Union of India began its march from Raisina Road and members of the Indian Youth Congress joined them.

Prohibitory orders were enforced under Section 163 BNSS in Parliament Street sub-division where the protest site is located, restricting any public meeting. Hundreds of Delhi Police, CAPF and RAF personnel blocked the two entry points of the Jantar Mantar protest site. The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation announced that entry and exit were closed at 12 stations, including those in the immediate vicinity of the protest site. Internet services were shut down at the protest site with shopkeepers facing difficulties in taking UPI payments.

Across India

In Keralam, district units of the Communist Party of India (Marxist) organised rallies demanding the resignation of Mr. Kumar.

In Srinagar, scores of Congress leaders and workers assembled at the party headquarters on M. A. Road. They tried to march towards the main road, but were stopped by police, who did not allow them to step outside the party office complex. In Jaipur, the AAP held a protest at Shaheed Smarak demanding Mr. Kumar’s resignation.

New EC portal options for Delhi poll officials

The limited options had been a concern for EROs dealing with cases where electors were struggling to produce the required documents within the stipulated hearing period.

More than 350 electors were marked ‘ineligible’ for not turning up for hearings, prompting Delhi Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) Ashok Kumar to caution EROs against choosing the option without proper verification. When reached for response on the new options and why they were introduced at this stage, the Delhi CEO’s Office and the EC did not respond. Earlier, uploading a hearing order was mandatory only in cases involving deletion or marking an elector ‘ineligible’.

For an elector to be marked for the final roll after a notice and hearing, the process involved the BLO and ERO and, in ‘no-mapping’ cases, the District Election Officer (DEO).

After the BLO uploaded documents along with an undertaking and photo attendance, the ERO checked the case and sent it to the DEO for verification. The ERO would then place the elector on the final roll based on the DEO’s feedback.

2 ‘intruders’ shot dead by BSF along Punjab border

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

Two unidentified suspected intruders were shot dead by the Border Security Force (BSF) along the India-Pakistan border in Punjab’s Tarn Taran district on Friday.

A senior BSF official told *The Hindu* that the bodies were lying about 50 metres beyond the border fence till a flag meeting with Pakistan Rangers was concluded.

The official said the identities of the intruders were yet to be established. At the flag meeting, the Pakistan Rangers sought the return of the bodies. “...it has been decided to hand over the bodies after the legal formalities are completed,” said the official.

Centre yet to extend SoO pact with Kuki-Zo groups

Suspension of Operations pact to be kept in abeyance till Kuki-Zo groups surrender all weapons, say officials; Meitei, Naga groups have sought its abrogation; Shah set to visit Manipur next week

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

Amid continuing violence between the Naga and Kuki groups in Manipur, the Union Home Ministry is yet to extend the Suspension of Operations (SoO) pact with the Kuki-Zo insurgent groups, a month after the one-year agreement expired.

On September 4, 2025, the Home Ministry, the Manipur government, and the Kuki-Zo groups had signed the SoO pact on “re-negotiated terms and conditions or ground rules,” after the Manipur government in February 2024 refused to extend the agreement, in force since 2008, in the wake of the violence that erupted between the Meitei and Kuki-Zo people on May 3, 2023.

Pact in abeyance

Government sources told *The Hindu* that the pact is in abeyance till all weapons are surrendered by the Kuki-Zo groups. The presence of a large number of weapons with civilians is one of the prime drivers of violence and killings in the



Weapons seizure: Arms and ammunition recovered during a security forces operation in Imphal in June 2025. ANI

northeastern State, a government official said. Meitei and Naga civil society groups, including Deputy Chief Minister Losli Dikho, have demanded the abrogation of the SoO pact.

Due to Naga-Kuki ethnic tensions, more than 40 people have been killed in Ukhrul, Kangpokpi, and Kamjong districts since February 7, three days after President’s Rule was revoked in the State.

A member of the Kuki-Zo SoO group said the one-year agreement expired on September 4, but they were yet to hear anything from the Ministry or Ajit Lal, Ministry’s Adviser, Northeast, and the interlocutor for peace talks.

vernment official said that it was decided to send 30 more companies of the CRPF (around 3,000 personnel) and two battalions of CoBRA (around 2,000 personnel) for deployment in the State.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah is expected to visit Senapati, a Naga-dominated district in Manipur, on October 7. This will be his second visit to the State since the 2023 violence. He had visited Imphal in 2024 to address a rally ahead of the Lok Sabha elections.

History of the pact

The tripartite pact was signed in 2008 by the United Peoples’ Front and the Kuki National Organisation, – a coalition of 24 insurgent groups – the Home Ministry, and the Manipur government following the Kuki-Naga clashes in the 1990s that killed hundreds. The insurgent groups demanded an independent land for the Kuki-Zo people. The pact has been extended periodically since 2008. After clashes erupted in 2023, there were strong demands from the valley areas to abrogate the SoO agreement.

Kin of 49 missing people in Manipur to get ₹10 lakh each

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

The Manipur Cabinet has approved a one-time financial assistance of ₹10 lakh each for the kin of the 49 people missing since the ethnic conflict erupted in the State on May 3, 2023.

Manipur’s Home Minister Konthoujam Govindas told the 60-member House in September that the conflicts – first between the Kuki-Zo and Meitei communities and then between the Kukis and Nagas – claimed 306 lives and displaced more than 60,000 people.

“The Cabinet approved a Home Department proposal for the one-time assistance of ₹10 lakh each for the survivors of the 49 missing persons as a special humanitarian measure,” Manipur Government spokesperson and MLA Sapam Ranjan Singh told journalists on October 1, after the end of the Cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Yunman Khemchand Singh. The spokesperson said the 49 people remain missing despite search efforts.

“The decision takes into account the difficulties faced by families of missing persons, particularly be-

The ethnic conflict in the State claimed 306 lives and displaced more than 60,000 people

cause existing legal and procedural requirements make it difficult for them to access compensation available to families of those officially declared dead,” he said. The law says a missing person is presumed dead only after seven years. Families of such people do not possess death certificates and autopsy reports required under the applicable Central assistance scheme.

“The families of the missing people have been going through hardships similar to those faced by the kin of people killed during the conflict. This was the reason why the government considered their case for the one-time assistance,” the spokesperson said.

Among other decisions, the Cabinet also approved an increase in ex-gratia assistance for Army and Central Armed Police Forces personnel killed or injured due to extremist violence while operating in Manipur.

Plea in Supreme Court dubs six-stanza Vande Mataram as a ‘divisive religious war song’

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

A petition in the Supreme Court has termed the six-stanza *Vande Mataram* a “divisive religious war song”, and said that government orders imposing a “sectarian prayer to particular goddesses of one particular religion as the National Song” violates fundamental rights of religion; attracts criminal law; and, basically, converts the Indian polity from a “secular republic” to a “theocracy”.

The plea filed by B.D. Borkar, a Phule-Ambedkarite and a member of the Scheduled Caste Buddhist community of Maharashtra, represented by jurist and advocate Mohan Gopal, said that a State compulsion expressed through two successive government orders on January 28 and July 9 would lead to



A tableau by the Ministry of Culture showing the verses of *Vande Mataram* during the Republic Day Parade on January 26, 2026. ANI

the “unstated but undeniable consequence of irreversibly deepening communal division and conflict in India by outraging the religious and spiritual feelings of minority religions”.

Mr. Borkar argued that the six-stanza version introduced by Bankim Chandra Chatterjee in his novel *Anandamath* would promote enmity and conflict between different com-

1870s. “This non-theistic song lauds the natural beauty of Mother Earth, describing the nation as a landscape and pays tribute to a non-deified motherland. The song was treated in this period as the National Song even though not officially declared so,” the petition said.

Song versus novel

“The novel *Anandamath* was written by Bankim Chandra Chatterjee after he had composed the two-stanza standalone version of *Vande Mataram*. It was first published in 1881. *Anandamath* presents an idea of India entirely different from that found in the two-stanza standalone song... *Anandamath* is a novel in which Hindu ascetics wage a holy religious war against Muslims who are violently killed and destroyed as a people... The centrepiece of *Anan-*

damath is a six-stanza war song in which the Hindu combatants pray to Goddesses Durga, Saraswati and Lakshmi as well as the country as a goddess for victory over Muslims,” the petition said.

The petition sought the court to intervene to quash the two orders, and stop any manner of compelling citizens, particularly schoolchildren, from singing or playing the six-stanza *Vande Mataram*. It said the court could direct that the two-stanza, standalone version of *Vande Mataram* alone be recognised, treated, performed and sung as the National Song.

On September 22, the top court had orally observed that a democratically-elected government cannot compel conscientious objectors to sing or play one or all the stanzas of *Vande Mataram* under the threat of penal action.



Pargat Singh

Pargat Singh appointed president of Punjab Cong.

The Hindu Bureau
CHANDIGARH

Putting an end to months of uncertainty around the position of the Punjab Congress chief, the All India Congress Committee (AICC) on Friday appointed Congress MLA Pargat Singh as the new president of the Punjab Pradesh Congress Committee (PPCC).

Mr. Singh, a former Minister and captain of the Indian men’s hockey team, has been given the new responsibility, after Congress leader Amarinder Singh Raja Warring formally submitted his resignation from the post of PPCC chief to former party president Rahul Gandhi.

Mr. Singh’s appointment is seen as a move to curb the ongoing power tussle in the Congress’s Punjab unit. The turf war, particularly between former Chief Minister Charanjit Singh Channi and Mr. Warring, was on public display for several months. To tackle this internal turmoil, the party’s central leadership replaced Bhupesh Baghel with Sachin Pilot as the party in-charge for Punjab last month. Now, replacing Mr. Warring with Mr. Singh is also being seen as an attempt to pacify the discontented leaders ahead of the crucial 2027 Assembly polls.

Party sources said that Mr. Singh’s appointment was driven largely by his clean, non-controversial image. By picking him, the party appears to have struck a balancing act, hoping he can bridge the divide between the two rival camps.

Congress appoints Aradhana Misra chief of its U.P. unit

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

The Congress on Friday appointed Aradhana Misra Mona president of the Uttar Pradesh Congress Committee. Imran Masood, Lok Sabha member from Saharanpur, was appointed working president, while Devinder Nishad and Alok Prasad have been appointed senior vice-presidents of the party.

Ms. Mona replaced Ajay Rai, who led the party as the State head for over three years.

Ms. Mona, a three-time MLA from the Rampur Khas Assembly seat under Pratapgarh district, is the daughter of party’s senior leader and Deputy Leader in the Rajya Sabha Pramod Tiwari.



Aradhana Misra Mona

The appointment, months before the Assembly polls, is seen as an attempt by the party to forge a social coalition of Brahmin-Muslim-Dalit communities as Ms. Mona and Mr. Masood hail from the Brahmin and Muslim communities, respectively.

Mr. Masood won the Saharanpur seat in 2024 by over 60,000 votes and is considered an influential Muslim leader from western Uttar Pradesh.

If Gyanesh Kumar goes, Modi will have to follow suit: Dipke

Despite lack of permission, over 4,000 people turn up at Mumbai's Shivaji Park seeking CEC's resignation; personalities like Shabana Azmi and Vishal Dadlani take part in protest; this is just a trailer, full picture at Jantar Mantar, says CJP

Snehal Mutha
Yohaán Varghese
MUMBAI

Thousands of protesters demonstrated outside Mumbai's Shivaji Park on Friday against alleged irregularities on electoral rolls and the Election Commission's special intensive revision (SIR), in a protest organised by the Cockroach Jan-ta Party (CJP) on the birth anniversary of Mahatma Gandhi.

Though police permission was not granted for the protest, the demonstrators numbering between 4,000 and 5,000 sat outside the historic Shivaji Park's gates in Dadar with the Tricolour in their hands, seeking the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. CJP conveners Abhijeet Dipke, Ashutosh Ranka, Saurav Das, and its head of legal affairs, Ratna Singh, addressed the protesters raising slogans such as "Gyanesh, it's done, bro".

The air was filled with slogans of Inquilab Zinda-bad, 'Ek Jeera, Do Ajjwain, Gyanesh karo resign', 'Gya-nu kaka...rajinama dya, ra-jinama dya', while the beats of patriotic songs



Seeking accountability: Singer Vishal Dadlani, CJP convener Abhijeet Dipke and others at a protest demanding the resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar at Shivaji Park in Mumbai on Friday. EMMANUAL YOGINI

such as *Rang De Basanti*, lent colour, sound, and defiance to an otherwise quiet afternoon.

'Freeze SIR process'

The CJP has demanded the resignation of Mr. Kumar and subsequent criminal proceedings against him. It has sought a freeze on the SIR process, restoration of the January 2025 voter list, and repeal of the 2023 law governing the appointment of Election Commissioners.

Addressing the protesters, Mr. Dipke said that if

Mr. Kumar was removed from his post, then Prime Minister Narendra Modi "will also have to go".

Mr. Ranka said: "Prime Minister Narendra Modi's shop is running because of the EC. Who the hell is Gyanesh [Kumar] to take away the Babasaheb's Constitution." He added that "this is just a trailer as the picture will be at Jantar Mantar in Delhi".

"We should not be afraid of detention. We should not be afraid of arrest. They will try to scare and threaten us, but we are

not going to be afraid," Mr. Ranka told the protesters.

Prominent figures, including actor Shabana Azmi and singer Vishal Dadlani, were present. "Since childhood we have been hearing voting is our right, but if the same right is taken away, then what will we do? We protest...", Ms. Azmi said.

Gangadhar Menon, 70, one of the protesters, said: "So far, we were talking that VVPAT (Voter Verified Paper Audit Trail) had problems, but this has gone way too deep. Now, they

are going for voters' list itself."

Comedian Rajiv Nigam, who addressed the gathering, said: "When our right to vote is taken away, all of us will have to raise our voices together."

NCP leader Anish Gawande said the SIR exercise had affected marginalised groups, claiming that "people from Assam who did not have documents because of floods" and "transgender persons without identity cards" had their names removed from the electoral rolls.

Regarding the number of protesters, a senior police official from Dadar present there said: "The inflow of people is reported to be 4,000-5,000 and police force deployed is around 800, along with riot control police units."

Senior citizen dies

A 75-year-old man who had come to witness the protest died of heart attack. He was identified as Gopalakrishna Subbairai Pillai, of Thane. Around 5 p.m., he complained of chest pain and was taken to a hospital, where he died, Deputy Commissioner of Police (DCP) Mahendra Pandit said.

The Hindu unveils Gandhi for Gen Z documentary

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Hindu on Friday launched its documentary *Gandhi for Gen Z* on the occasion of Gandhi Jayanti.

Editor Suresh Nambath and CEO L.V. Navaneeth released the documentary in the presence of N. Murali, Chairman, The Hindu Group Publishing Private Ltd., and N. Ram, Director, The Hindu Group Publishing Private Ltd.

The 35-minute documentary looks at the large-scale student protests earlier this year through the lens of Mahatma Gandhi's teachings about ushering in change through disciplined, non-violent protests. It proposes that the philosophies of the Mahatma may be relevant even to a generation that has not studied him beyond mentions in school textbooks.

Opening with scenes of the protests at Jantar Mantar in June and moving between archival footage of Gandhi's life and work during the freedom struggle, the film delves into how a protest triggered by a leaked examination paper expanded into an expression of young people's anxieties about today's political climate.

Besides, it looks at how the protesting students used the oldest tools in the country's political memory



N. Ram, Director, The Hindu Group; N. Murali, Chairman; L.V. Navaneeth, CEO; and Suresh Nambath, Editor, *The Hindu*, at the launch of the documentary in Chennai. S.R. RAGHUNATHAN

– hunger strikes and disciplined non-violent protests – tools that Gandhiji had created decades earlier.

It examines how the young protesters placed Gandhiji and Dr. B.R. Ambedkar side by side, drawing lessons from both, despite an old, established discourse that pits the two against each other.

Footage of police action against the protesters and their lack of retaliatory violence reinforced the Gandhian connection: *ahimsa*, both as moral principle and as a political strategy.

The documentary features interviews with historian and author Ramachandra Guha, former West Bengal Governor and Gandhiji's grandson Gopalakrishna Gandhi, social activist and Gandhiji's great-grandson Tushar Gandhi, Cockroach Janta Party's chief spokesperson Saurav Das, and Self-Em-

ployed Women's Association director Mirai Chatterjee.

"The documentary is very relevant and timely because it brings out, in a meaningful and real way, the relevance of India's freedom struggle, which was led by Gandhiji, particularly the method of mass protests and the reasons for not using violence," said Mr. Ram, noting that the connection between the freedom struggle and the student protests is portrayed very authentically in the documentary.

The documentary was spearheaded by Pradeep Gairola, business head – digital, The Hindu Group. It was directed by Shikha Kumari A. and edited by Naveen Kumar V., with camerawork and post-production handled by members of *The Hindu's* video team. It is available on *The Hindu's* YouTube channel.

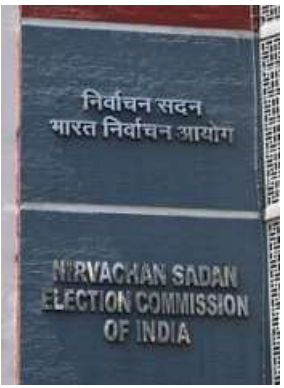
EC directs BLOs to enrol voters left out of SIR rolls within a month

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Election Commission (EC) has directed the Chief Electoral Officers (CEO) of all States and Union Territories where the special intensive revision (SIR) has been completed or is under way to compare the pre-SIR voter lists with the current ones and enrol, within one month, those who have been left out but are eligible.

In a letter to the CEOs of all States and Union Territories, the EC has said that booth-level officers (BLO) should prepare a list of electors whose names had been left out, and make door-to-door visits to ascertain their present status and ensure their enrolment through Form 6 if the concerned person is found eligible.

"BLOs shall compare the current electoral roll with the pre-SIR electoral roll and identify such electors whose names were there in the pre-SIR roll but



who are not included in the current electoral roll and prepare a list of such electors," the letter said.

It further said that BLOs shall undertake house-to-house visits in respect of such identified electors to ascertain their present status and facilitate enrolment through Form 6, wherever the person is found to be eligible.

The EC's letter, which was issued after a video conferencing with all the CEOs, suggested that the BLOs may cover at least 20-25 electors in a week so as to complete this exercise

within a period of about one month.

"They shall also indicate the present status of each such elector in the list prepared by them. The electors for whom Form 6 has been filled up will also be indicated."

The BLOs will share this list with the BLAs of recognised political parties and the EROs, along with filled-in Form 6 application forms and their field verification reports.

Booth-level camps

Apart from this, booth-level camps shall be organised to facilitate submission of applications for enrolment. Special camps may also be organised for enrolment of people living in night shelters, labour colonies as well as for homeless and marginalised persons.

Till now, approximately 13.3 crore names have been deleted from the electoral rolls in States where the SIR process has been completed or is under way.

An analysis by *The Hindu* found that around 2.7 crore or 21% have been declared dead, and of the remaining, approximately 1.01 crore have been flagged as multiple entry cases and 9.5 crore marked in the absent/shifted/others category. This in effect means that 72% of the voters whose names have been deleted could be back in the voter lists once the SIR process is completed.

The EC has already announced a special drive to enrol new voters.

However, former Chief Election Commissioner S.Y. Quraishi has questioned the EC's move to re-enrol voters using Form 6.

He said Form 6 cannot be filled by a deleted voter. "It's only for NEW voters. All those who have been forced to fill it have committed criminal offence carrying one year prison. EC officials who forced them are abettors to crime. This press note shows EC's abetment!", he said in a post on X.

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

The Election Commission's (EC) special "door-to-door" drive to re-enrol any voter left behind during the SIR process through Form 6 will not be applicable to the more than 20 lakh voters in West Bengal whose cases are pending before the appellate tribunals. This could create two parallel re-enrolment routes, one through the tribunals and one through Form 6 applications to electoral registration officers (EROs). The EC has directed Form 6 applicants to be cleared within a month, while the tribunal appellants could wait several years.

A senior EC official told *The Hindu* that while booth-level Officers (BLOs) would re-check if any voters are left out among the ASDD (absent/shifted/dead/duplicate) list which was issued after the enumeration phase, those whose cases are in the tri-



People gather to submit their applications to a tribunal set up to hear appeals related to SIR in Alipore, Kolkata. FILE PHOTO

bunals "is different as it is already under adjudication".

According to an affidavit submitted by the EC in the Supreme Court, 22.21 lakh appeals are pending before the tribunals in West Bengal.

The appellate tribunals came out of Supreme Court's supervision of the SIR. Judicial officers, drawn from a list sent by the Calcutta High Court at the Supreme Court's direction, were adjudicating the roughly 60 lakh "doubtful

"logical discrepancy". Both groups were called for hearings after the draft roll was published on December 16 last year.

Around 60 lakh cases were still unresolved when the final roll was published on February 28 after the hearings had cleared the rest.

Unresolved appeals

The West Bengal Congress has said that since the enrolment drive was announced just before the October 6 by-elections in Nandigram and Rejinagar, where over 6,000 and 12,000 appeals, respectively, remain pending, these voters would be deprived of their vote for a second consecutive time. The party unit chief, Shubhankar Sarkar Prasenjit Bose, in a letter to the EC, asked for all 22.21 lakh appellants to the electoral roll to be restored provisionally until their appeals are finally decided, or to convert all pending tribunal appeals into Form 6 applications.

Cong. accuses EC of 'lying' about ECINet, demands accountability

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Friday accused the Election Commission (EC) of "lying" about the legality of its ECINet platform and violating electoral laws, with party general secretary Jairam Ramesh demanding accountability for what he described as "violations of the law and the Constitution".

Mr. Ramesh said the EC, in a September 26 press note, had announced the formation of a committee to certify that ECINet complied with the relevant Acts and Rules. He described the move as "damage con-

trol but actually damage enhancing".

"This should never have been in doubt at all in the first place if the intentions of CEC Gyanesh Kumar were honest – which they were not," he said.

ECINet was launched on January 22 with the stated objective of enhancing transparency and public trust. The EC had said at the launch that the platform had been "developed in strict accordance with the law". "All of this was a lie," Mr. Ramesh said.

He alleged that by restricting electoral registration officers' (EROs) access to the ECINet voter-roll system and overruling EROs

in Goa, West Bengal and other States, the EC had violated the Representation of the People Act, 1950 and the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960.

"Both these laws establish that the ERO has statutory authority over the electoral roll," he said, citing a September 24 letter from the Maharashtra Chief Electoral Officer seeking correction of the alleged irregularity.

"Starting today, the INDIA janbandhan, citizens and many civil society organisations will hit the streets across the country demanding accountability for these violations," Mr. Ramesh said.

Panel of ex-judges to inquire into SIR aftermath

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A lawyers' group issued a statement on Friday announcing the constitution of an independent panel of former Supreme Court and High Court judges to enquire into growing concerns regarding the design, implementation, and consequences of the special intensive revision (SIR) exercise undertaken by the Election Commission.

The Lawyers Association for Constitution (LAFAC) said the panel aims at coming up with a report by December 2026.

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No. :- 916
Date :-25.09.2026
Notice Invision Bid No. 08/2026-27
NIB No. :- PWD2627A3001
Bids for Various works are invited from interested bidders from **01.10.2026 9.00 AM to 01.10.2026 Upto 06.00 PM**. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>) and (<http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in>) of the state, and department website. The approximate value of procurement of **05 Works is Rs. 301.23 Lacs.**
UBN No :-

1	PWD2627WSOB13528
2	PWD2627WSOB13529
3	PWD2627WSOB13530
4	PWD2627WSOB13531
5	PWD2627SLRC13532

(Mahendra Singh Saini)
Executive Engineer
P.W.D. Dn. Vallabhnagar

DIPRC/16805/2026

APPOINTMENT

GOVERNMENT OF PUDUCHERRY
DIRECTORATE OF HIGHER & TECHNICAL EDUCATION
LAWSPET, PUDUCHERRY

No.1409/DHTE/Est/E5/PTU-VC/2026
APPOINTMENT OF VICE-CHANCELLOR OF PUDUCHERRY TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY

Date:01.10.2026

The Search-cum-Selection Committee for the appointment of Vice-Chancellor for Puducherry Technological University, Puducherry invites applications/nominations from "Distinguished academicians, with a minimum of ten years of experience as Professor in the field of Engineering and Technology in a University or ten years of experience in reputed research and / or academic administrative organisation with proof of having demonstrated academic leadership".

The Vice-Chancellor shall hold office for a period of five years, or till he attains the age of superannuation as specified by the University Grants Commission from time to time, whichever is earlier, with no provision for re-appointment/extension.

The application form is available in the website dhte.py.gov.in. The filled-in application form should be submitted in a sealed envelope clearly marked "Application for the post of Vice-Chancellor" addressed to the Director, Directorate of Higher & Technical Education, Thokaplayar Street, Lawspet, Puducherry – 605008 and the soft copy in .pdf format should be emailed to est@dhtepdy.edu.in. The Search-cum-Selection Committee reserves the right to consider or not to consider any application and recommend any person(s) of eminence outside the list of such applications.

The filled-in application in the prescribed format should be submitted on or before 5.30 PM of 31.10.2026.

Sd/-
DIRECTOR
(Higher & Technical Education)

NO.221/DIPIAD(PRESS)/2026-27

INBRIEF



Amazon Now expands to more than 120 Indian cities

Amazon has expanded its ultra-fast delivery service, Amazon Now, to more than 120 cities across India, doubling its footprint in two weeks as the e-commerce giant steps up its delivery network ahead of the festive season. Amazon Now offers of thousands of products, including groceries, fruits and vegetables, frozen food, personal care items, fashion and beauty products, small appliances and home and kitchen goods. Orders are fulfilled via a network of almost 800 micro-fulfillment and urban fulfillment centres, the firm said. Amazon said in September that Amazon Now had crossed \$1 billion in annualised gross sales in India based on the previous three-month period. The company plans to expand the service to more than 300 cities and build what it describes as India's largest "delivery-in-minutes" network. PTI

FPIs turn net sellers, pull out ₹35,860 crore in September

After two consecutive months of buying, foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) turned net sellers in September pulling out ₹35,860 crore from Indian equities amid global uncertainties, elevated U.S. interest rates and high crude oil prices. The selling continued into October, with FPIs pulling out ₹9,232 crore from equities on October 1, as per data from Central Depository Services Ltd. The outflows came after FPIs invested ₹20,200 crore in Indian equities in July and ₹29,630 crore in August. With the latest selling, FPIs have now withdrawn about ₹2.7 lakh crore from Indian equities so far in 2026 vis a vis ₹1.66 lakh crore outflow in entire 2025. Rajesh Singla, fund manager & CEO, Alpha AMC, said this was largely due to factors such as elevated crude prices amid Hormuz-related supply risks, a weak rupee, firm U.S. bond yields, profit-booking and rotation towards AI-led North Asian markets. PTI

Decoding lifetime value for revenue visibility in auto component orders

Balasubramanyam C. P.
CHENNAI

When an auto-component maker announces a ₹2,000-crore order win, investors want to know how much will translate into revenue – and when.

The answer is not evident from the headline number. Component suppliers often win contracts for a vehicle platform's life with volumes ramping up, peaking and then tapering. This is why some firms use lifetime value (LTV) metric than annualised order value to measure revenue.

LTV is the estimated total sales a supplier expects from a vehicle programme over its production life.

Rane (Madras), for instance, shifted from annualised business wins to LTV in the June quarter. In its Q1 FY27 earnings call, the firm said it benchmarked the practice against Indian and global peers as most programmes ran for more than six years. It reported ₹2,040 crore of new business on LTV basis.

A Rane official told *The Hindu* that LTV is derived from the expected programme life and estimated OEM volumes when the order is secured. Dividing LTV by programme duration, it said, would not yield a meaningful annual figure because volumes vary over the programme.

Global suppliers use the metric too. Autoliv said in its 2025 annual report that delivery contracts typically cover a vehicle model's life, generally 5-7 years. Its LTV estimates factor in prices and production volumes while the typical lead



Packing dilemma: Staff pack commercial vehicles parts inside an auto component manufacturing facility in Rajkot. REUTERS

time from order intake to start of production is one to three years.

For investors, LTV provides visibility on the long-term business pipeline. But it does not answer the immediate question: when does the revenue arrive?

Consider two programmes: one with an LTV of ₹1,000 crore over 10 years and another of ₹700 crore over three years. The first has larger LTV but the second could generate revenue faster.

A Chennai-based chartered accountant with more than 15 years of practice, who reviewed the issue for *The Hindu*, said LTV indicates the size of a long-term programme but does not provide sufficient near-term revenue visibility by itself. Investors should ideally see LTV alongside programme duration, start of production (SOP), annualised/peak value and revenue ramp-up, the CA said. Customer-volume assumptions and other conditions also matter.

Dividing LTV by years
Rane's ₹2,040-crore LTV divided by six years gives ₹340 crore a year. But that is only an average not a revenue forecast. Volumes

India has no excess capacity, bans forced-labour imports

Mr. Goyal's remarks come even as U.S.T.R levied 10% 'forced labour' tariff on India imports and is in the process of investigating country for structural excess capacity, which may result in more tariffs

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal told the G20 Trade Ministers meet in the U.S. India did not have structural excess capacity in sectors identified by Washington and it had taken steps to ban import of goods made using forced labour.

This comes at a time when the U.S. had already levied a 10% tariff on India for not doing enough to stop imports of goods made using forced labour, and is now probing it and other countries for structural excess capacity which could invite more tariffs.

On both issues, Mr. Goyal said steps must not be unilateral and be compliant with World Trade Organization (WTO) rules.

"Shri Piyush Goyal participated in the concluding day of the G20 Trade Ministers' Meeting in Milwaukee and spoke in sessions on structural excess capacity and production, updating the Most-Favoured-Nation principle, ending forced labour in global supply chains and the closing session," the Commerce Ministry said in a release.

The G20 Presidency is held by the U.S. for 2026.

On forced labour

The Office of the U.S. Trade Representative (USTR) had in July levied additional tariffs on 60 countries, including India, as a result of



Trade tangle: Goyal during a meeting with United States Trade Representative Jamieson Greer. PTI

its probe into whether the countries had done enough to stop the import of goods made using forced labour.

Tariff on imports from India was set at 10%.

On ending forced labour in global supply chains, Mr. Goyal said India's commitment to the elimination of forced labour is "absolute and unconditional".

"He noted Article 23 of the Constitution prohibits forced labour as a fundamental right, enforceable by the Supreme Court," it added. "He said India ratified International Labour Organization (ILO) Conventions 29 and 105 and, in July, amended Foreign Trade Policy to prohibit import of goods produced using forced labour."

'No unilateral actions'

He said steps at the border must be based on "specific and verifiable evidence rather than presumptions

about entire countries, regions or sectors" and must respect due process and WTO rules, adding ILO remains the competent, universal and tripartite body for labour standards.

"India supports the objective of eliminating forced labour and voluntary exchange of good practices among G20 members, provided such cooperation does not involve monitoring of members, create new obligations or result in information being used as a basis for unilateral trade action," Mr. Goyal said.

No excess capacity

The USTR is also in the process of probing 60 countries structural excess capacity and production and if this was hurting the U.S. economy. This could result in additional tariffs on imports from India.

On structural excess capacity and output, he Mr.

said India was the fastest-growing large economy in the world, with an economy driven by local demand and is building manufacturing value chains "from design to finished goods".

"He said India's manufacturing capacity serves its domestic and global needs and that, in the sectors identified by the G20 Presidency, India does not have structural excess capacity," the release said.

Mr. Goyal said India shares the concerns of many G20 members that trade-distorting support in some economies can lead to "dumping and predatory pricing".

'WTO-compliant steps'

However, he emphasised such concerns were addressed via steps consistent with the WTO, such as anti-dumping and countervailing duties, based on evidence and subject to judicial review.

"He emphasised industrial capacity in itself is not the issue while distortions can arise where geographical concentration of production is driven by hidden subsidies and support. Diversification of production and supply chains is a legitimate objective but cannot be used as a pretext for measures outside WTO rules or for shifting the burden of adjustment onto developing countries, which must retain policy space to industrialise."

UPI volume jumps 27% to touch 145 bn in first half of FY27

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

UPI transactions through popular Unified Payments Interface (UPI) in volume terms have witnessed a 27% jump to around 145 billion in the first half of the current fiscal year.

This is against UPI volume 114 billion during April-September quarter of the previous financial year, as per data released by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI).

However, the UPI transaction during the value term rose a slightly lower rate of 20% to ₹177 lakh crore as against ₹148 lakh crore during the first six months of the current financial year. As regards September, the UPI volume moderated by 1.7% to 24.07 billion compared to 24.5 billion last month.

On a month-on-month basis, value, too, declined 1.5% to ₹29.37 lakh crore against ₹29.82 lakh crore in August. The figures come a fortnight ahead of the implementation of the new merchant discount rate fee on high-value UPI payments for merchants.

Industry watchers attributed the dip to the fact August has 31 days versus 30 in September and pointed out average transactions/day were higher in September at 802 million versus 791 million in August. NPCI, an initiative of the RBI and the Indian Banks' Association, is an umbrella organisation for retail payments and settlement systems in India. It runs UPI used for real-time payments between peers or at merchants' end while making purchases.

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
MINISTRY OF MINES
INDIAN BUREAU OF MINES
Nagpur, Maharashtra – 440001. Phone: 0712-2560041 email: merd@ibm.gov.in
T-45/5/2026-TS-IBM_HQ Date: 01/10/2026

NOTICE INVITING APPLICATIONS FOR REGISTRATION AS MINERAL EXCHANGE IN INDIA

Indian Bureau of Mines (IBM) invites sealed applications for the registration of companies meeting the Eligibility Criteria under Rule 6 of the Mineral Exchange Rules, 2026.

The Objective, Function, Eligibility, Fees and other details have been defined in the said rules notified by the Central Government on 30th June 2026. The Notice Inviting Applications (NIA) document seeking applications for registration as Mineral Exchange contains the bidding schedule, brief objective, scope of work, the eligibility criteria, procedure for filing application, grant of registration for establishing & operating the electronic platform for the Mineral Exchange etc.

The NIA document containing application form shall be available for download from website www.ibm.gov.in on **03rd October 2026** and the last date of submission of Application is **02nd November 2026 up to 1500 hrs.**

Sealed envelope containing application as provided in NIA and receipt of non-refundable fees of Rs. 3,00,000 (Rupees Three Lakh only) payable through Bharatkosh must be submitted in person or sent through registered post with "Application for Registration as Mineral Exchange" clearly mentioned on top of the sealed envelope so that it reaches this office before the last day of submission. The application must be sent to the below mentioned address:

**"Controller of Mines, Mineral Exchange Cell, MDR Division
2nd Floor, A-Block, Indira Bhavan, Indian Bureau of Mines
Civil Lines, Nagpur, Maharashtra – 440001"**

Sd
Controller of Mines
Mineral Exchange Cell, IBM

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH


Dr. CHAVALY MANI SASTRY
February 25, 1938 - October 1, 2026
Fondly remembered by her Family and Friends.
Chavalay Venkatesh and Chavalay Shailashree
Gajjala Shailaja & Gajjala Nagendra Sundaram
Sharmila Chavalay
Kirti Bhushan and Soujanya Kartikeya and Akanksha Kritika Keerthana Ira Vedansh

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GOBARdhan eyes 10-fold increase in CBG output: Puri

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

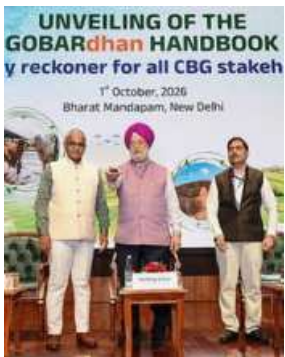
The ₹23,731-crore GOBARdhan scheme aims to drive a 10-fold increase in compressed biogas (CBG) production, save more than ₹40,000 crore in fuel imports, add over ₹75,000 crore to GDP and create more than 1.5 lakh jobs, as the government seeks to turn agricultural and organic waste into a new source of domestic energy.

Speaking at the formal launch of the scheme, Oil Minister Hardeep Singh Puri said the scheme provides capital assistance as well as guaranteed offtake of the renewable fuel made by processing organic waste such as agricultural residue, animal dung, food waste and other biomass.

Capital support plus guaranteed offtake is likely to lift CBG (essentially methane-rich gas) from current 0.4 million standard cubic metre per day to 4-6 mmscmd, he said, hoping this would help in achieving the target of raising share of natural gas – a cleaner-burning, lower-pollution fuel – in energy basket to 15% by 2030 from the current 6-7%.

Replace fossil fuel

The scheme is designed to replace about 10 million tonne of fossil fuel with clean gas, potentially cutting more than 40 million tonne of CO2 emissions, while producing around 250 million tonne of organic manure for farmers.



Puri launches the GOBARdhan Scheme, at Bharat Mandapam, in New Delhi. PIB VIA PTI

Mr. Puri said the programme would help turn farmers from "Annadatas to also being the Urjadatas".

The scheme provides capital assistance of up to ₹30 crore per CBG project across the two eligible capital-support components. For greenfield plants, assistance is set at ₹1.25 crore per tonne per day (TPD) of eligible CBG capacity. Brownfield projects can receive support at 50% of the applicable greenfield rate for additional capacity created through fresh investment.

Plant upgrades

Existing biogas plants upgraded to make CBG can get ₹0.60 crore/TPD, subject to a ₹5-crore project ceiling. To make CBG projects commercially viable, the Centre is offering producers assured offtake of up to 100% eligible output at an administered price of ₹2,110 per million British thermal units - equivalent to about ₹98/kg.

MUNICIPAL CORPORATION KOTA (RAJ.)
Add :- C.A.D. Circle, Dusshehra Ground, Kota
No. : NNK/ELECT/2026/1636-1643 Date : 28.09.2026

Re Notice -Inviting Bid

Bid for "Supply and Installation of decorative poles from Jawahar nagar main road Anil Kothari clinic to MBS Road in Municipal Corporation Kota." are invited from interested bidders from 01.10.2026 to 21.10.2026 Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>. <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in> of the state and www.kotamc.org. department website.

Estimated Amount : 608.14 Lac
NIB code : DLB2627A8025
UBN : DLB2627WLB020738
Raj.Samwad/C/26/11162

Executive Engineer (Electrical)
MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, KOTA

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OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION R.S.PURA

SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Short e-NIT No DRSP/91 of 2026-27 Dated 29-09-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of J&K e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Bidders as per Instruction to Bidder (ITB) and Terms of Reference at Annexure-I. The Bidder (Firm/Consultant/Agency/Company) should have the eligibility as per Annexure-II under Eligibility Criteria for the following work:-

S. No	Name of Work	Estimated Cost of the project (₹ in Lacs)	Advertised Cost (₹ in Lacs)	Cost of document (₹ in Rs)	Earnest Money (₹ in Rs)	Time and date of opening of tender	Type of Consultant
1	2	3	4	5	6	8	9
1	Providing Consultancy and other allied services with all working drawings (Digital Layout Plan, B.O.Q, Structural Design)including technical vetting of drawings from DIOC/NIT/IT and Conducting of all required soil investigations for the "Construction of 12 mtr span Double lane bridge at Dharp near Ravidass Temple Sikanderpur(Under Bridge Sector, Capex Budget 2026-27)"	140.86	2.09	600	4180	(1300 Hrs) on or after 15-10-2026	Architectural Consultants / Structural consultant

Position of AAA :- Accorded by the Superintendent Engineer PWD(R&B) Circle South, Jammu vide Order No. 111 of 2026 dated: 24/09/2026.

Project Authority :- Chief Engineer PWD(R&B) Department Zone Jammu

Time allowed to L1 for submission of requisite vetted structural drawings and designs :- 01 Month after issuance of LOA

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website <http://jktenders.gov.in> as per below schedule :

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	29-09-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 29-09-2025 to 14-10-2026
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	05-10-2026 at 1300 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura
4	Bid submission Start Date	29-09-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	14-10-2026 upto 1600 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	15-10-2026 on or after 1300 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura. In case mentioned bid opening date happens to be a holiday then Bid shall be opened at the same time on the next working day
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids (Online)	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

Sd/-
Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura

DIP/J-11594/26 Oct 01 2026

How Hansi flicked the Raphinha switch

The Barcelona coach has unlocked a turbocharged version of the Brazilian attacker by shifting him from the wing to the centre-forward's position. Raphinha has exploded in his new role, rising to the top of the LaLiga scoring charts ahead of Lamine Yamal and Kylian Mbappe

Reuters
Associated Press

The move from the wing to the middle helped Ousmane Dembele assume his final form as an unstoppable force in the 2024-25 season and win the Ballon d'Or.

A similar shift from the flanks to the central spaces as a No. 9 appears to have unleashed a turbocharged version of Raphinha at Barcelona this season. The Brazil international has exploded in his new role, scoring 14 goals in eight matches, 12 in seven games in LaLiga, moving to the top of the scoring charts ahead of Lamine Yamal and Kylian Mbappe.

The striker hunt

Barcelona had spent the close season searching for a centre-forward after Robert Lewandowski left as a free agent for Major League Soccer, with Atletico Madrid's Julian Alvarez and Inter Milan captain Lautaro Martinez high on its list. The summer chase for Alvarez, which developed into a messy saga, ended in frustration for Barcelona, leaving the club short up front.

Barcelona eventually signed Gabriel Jesus as a rotational option for Hansi Flick's squad, but the surprise solution has come from within, with Raphinha moving from his hybrid attacking midfielder-right wing role into the centre-forward position.

"The idea was to bring in a forward with good movement and the ability to link up with others, and Julian [Alvarez] was one such player," said Barcelona sporting director Deco.

"We are happy because we discovered a new face of Raphinha. But more important is that he's happy too. It is different for him, because sometimes he's not in contact with the ball all the time like he used to. He needs to be prepared to attack behind the defenders. We expected that he could do well, but not at this level," Deco added. Indeed,

Yes, I had doubts. People judge you for goals, you're playing as a striker. And then there's the fact that you're playing in the spot where the one and only Robert Lewandowski played

RAPHINHA

the change in Raphinha's fortunes at Barcelona has been sudden and spectacular. He was convinced he was leaving two years ago after growing increasingly frustrated under Xavi Hernandez. But Flick's arrival as coach in 2024 proved a turning point: Raphinha, who has thrived under the German, was appointed captain at the start of the season after Ronald Araujo and Marc-Andre ter Stegen left the club and Frenkie de Jong was sidelined by a knee injury.

The coach's belief

In his first conversation with Raphinha, Flick had told the attacker that he believed in his talent. The start of this season has revealed the extent of the coach's belief. Flick had an idea that the 29-year-old's strengths would translate well from the wing to the centre. More to the point, he had the conviction to back his belief.

"In pre-season we did a few tests: the manager liked what he saw and told me a bit about his idea," Raphinha told the *Guardian*. "The adaptation came over the last two years, getting used to coming inside, closer to goal. But we tested [me

as] an actual No. 9 and it went well.

"There's the occasional detail that has to be explained, but I'm OK. Before Elche [on the opening day], he asked if I was comfortable there or wanted to go back to my position. I said it was fine, see how it goes, we can always change back."

There has been no reason to change. With 31

He gives us a lot, his dynamic is top but also without the ball he's good. He has that incredible hunger and intensity, the mentality and attitude we need

HANSI FLICK

goals in seven straight league wins – that's an average of 4.3 goals per match – Barcelona has the hottest attack in Europe, and Raphinha has led the charge in blistering fashion, scoring at will, including back-to-back hat-tricks.

The second of those came in Barcelona's biggest test of the season so far, at the Ramon Sanchez-Pizjuan in the final league fixture before the international break. With his side down a goal to Sevilla after 19 minutes, Raphinha responded in style. He scored a perfect hat-trick, applying three different finishes. All of them would have made the game's top No. 9s proud, for they showcased his skill, instinct, speed and sheer desire to score.

The first goal featured a diagonal in-to-out run onto Andreas Christensen's pass, a tricky feint that put his chasing marker on the ground, and a right-footed finish to the far corner. For the second, he burst out of the defender's blindside to head a Yamal floater expertly. He chipped the keeper off his stronger left foot for the third, this time after an out-to-in run.

"We know the quality of Raphinha," Flick said after the game. "He gives us a lot, his dynamic is top but also without the ball he's good. He has that incredible hunger and intensity, the mentality and attitude we need. After these eight games, I think he's very happy to play as a No. 9."

Interestingly, for someone who has taken to the job like a duck to water, Raphinha wasn't sure at the beginning. "Yes, I had doubts," Raphinha told *Rac+I* when asked about the transition. "Because people judge you for goals, at the end of the day, you're playing as a striker. And then there's the fact that you're playing in the spot where the one and only Robert Lewandowski played. So if you don't score goals, people judge you for that, they demand that from you."

The former Leeds United forward, who joined Barcelona in 2022, has now scored 89 goals in 185 appearances for the Blaugrana, which places him among the top 30 scorers in the club's history. He needs just five more goals to equal the legendary Ronaldinho.

Tellingly, 69 of Raphinha's Barcelona goals have come under Flick, who has led the Catalans to LaLiga titles in each of his two seasons.

"I've always said it and I will always say it, he's the manager that changed both my mentality within the club and also what I thought about myself," Raphinha told *DAZN*. "I'm very grateful for him, and I will demonstrate it whenever I can."

What lies ahead

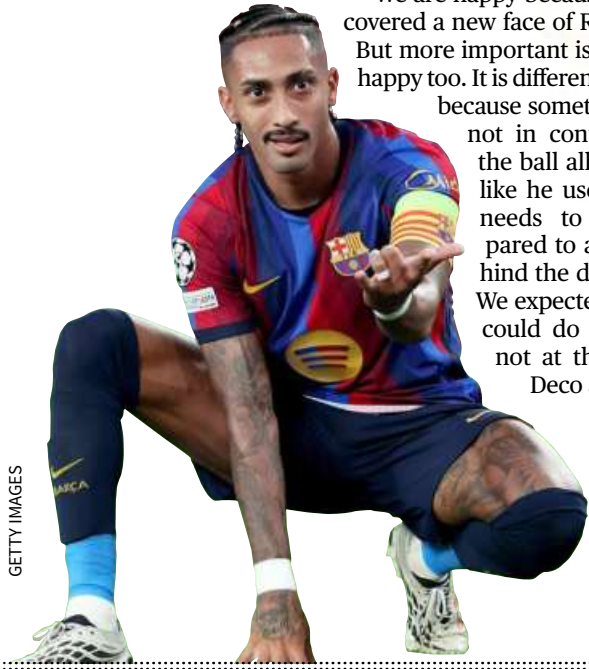
It's no surprise that the player wants to extend his stay at the club.

"Given the way I've started the season, I think I can keep going for a few more years. I'm in spectacular physical shape so [retirement] is some way off. I would be very happy to extend my contract and, hopefully, finish my career here without having to go elsewhere," Raphinha told *RACI* radio.

"It's always important to keep in mind that you need to improve in some areas. I'll never say I'm at my peak, because I always try to improve as much as I can. There's surely something more I can contribute to the team than what I'm currently giving."

It will be interesting to see just how Raphinha's time at No. 9 plays out. Will he have a season for the ages like Dembele did and maybe even enjoy a late-career swing as an elite striker? Or will it be no more than a short-term fix, even if it is successful?

All we know for sure is that Raphinha, like he has through his career, will give it everything.



GETTY IMAGES

STACKING UP

ATP Men's Top 15				
#	Player	Age	Points	Events
1	Jannik Sinner	25	11,000	16
2	Alexander Zverev	29	9,630	19
3	Carlos Alcaraz	23	5,060	16
4	Ben Shelton	23	4,680	22
5	Felix Auger-Aliassime	26	3,890	22
6	Daniil Medvedev	30	3,710	23
7	Flavio Cobolli	24	3,680	25
8	Frances Tiafoe	28	3,380	21
9	Arthur Fils	22	3,150	18
10	Alex de Minaur	27	3,150	23
11	Novak Djokovic	39	2,980	15
12	Taylor Fritz	28	2,880	21
13	Rafael Nadal	20	2,659	21
14	Jakub Mensik	21	2,405	20
15	Learner Tien	20	2,395	20



Top Indians



Sumit Nagal
Rank 249 ▼ 1 spot



Dhakshinewar Suresh
Rank 364 ▼ 5 spots

WTA Women's Top 15				
#	Player	Age	Points	Events
1	Elena Rybakina	27	9,901	21
2	Aryna Sabalenka	28	7,810	20
3	Jessica Pegula	32	7,265	19
4	Coco Gauff	22	7,244	19
5	Mirra Andreeva	19	5,841	21
6	Linda Noskova	21	5,328	20
7	Elina Svitolina	32	4,809	17
8	Karolina Muchova	30	4,683	20
9	Iga Swiatek	25	4,119	19
10	Marta Kostyuk	24	4,040	18
11	Amanda Anisimova	25	3,363	15
12	Belinda Bencic	29	2,925	19
13	Iva Jovic	18	2,841	23
14	Diana Shnaider	22	2,588	23
15	Victoria Mboko	20	2,521	19

Top Indians



Sahaja Yamalapalli
Rank 354 ▼ 5 spots



Vaishnavi Adkar
Rank 374 ▼ 13 spots

F1 Drivers' standings				
#	Driver	Team	Points	Wins
1	A.K. Antonelli	Mercedes	302	8
2	G. Russell	Mercedes	236	3
3	L. Hamilton	Ferrari	199	1
4	L. Norris	McLaren	186	2
5	C. Leclerc	Ferrari	179	1
6	M. Verstappen	Red Bull	163	0
7	O. Piastri	McLaren	120	0
8	I. Hadjar	Red Bull	86	0
9	L. Lawson	RB	59	0
10	P. Gasly	Alpine	41	0
11	A. Lindblad	RB	37	0
12	F. Colapinto	Alpine	27	0
13	O. Bearman	Haas	20	0
14	G. Bortoleto	Audi	10	0
15	N. Hulkenberg	Audi	7	0
16	E. Ocon	Haas	7	0
17	C. Sainz	Williams	7	0
18	A. Albon	Williams	5	0
19	F. Alonso	Aston Martin	3	0
20	Y. Tsunoda	RB	1	0
21	V. Bottas	Cadillac	0	0
22	S. Perez	Cadillac	0	0
23	L. Stroll	Aston Martin	0	0



A.K. Antonelli



G. Russell

F1 Constructors' standings			
Pos	Team	Points	Wins
1	Mercedes	538	11
2	Ferrari	378	2
3	McLaren	306	2
4	Red Bull	263	0
5	RB	83	0
6	Alpine	68	0
7	Haas	27	0
8	Audi	17	0
9	Williams	12	0
10	Aston Martin	3	0
11	Cadillac	0	0

Badminton Men's ranking			
#	Player	Points	Events
1	Kunlavut Vitidsarn	86,915	16
2	Christo Popov	86,632	19
3	Jonatan Christie	84,431	16
4	Shi Yu Qi	84,075	13
5	Chou Tien Chen	83,680	25
6	Anders Antonsen	83,655	16
7	Kodai Naraoka	77,540	18
8	Alex Lanier	76,985	15
9	Victor Lai	76,465	17
10	Alwi Farhan	70,099	16
11	Lin Chun-Yi	64,924	17
12	Li Shi Feng	64,533	15
13	Loh Kean Yew	63,140	18
14	Lakshya Sen	62,813	20
15	Toma Junior Popov	62,697	19

Top Indians



Lakshya Sen
Rank 14



Ayush Shetty
Rank 20

Badminton Women's ranking			
#	Player	Points	Events
1	An Se Young	1,21,287	14
2	Wang Zhi Yi	1,03,989	15
3	Akane Yamaguchi	1,02,576	17
4	Chen Yu Fei	86,651	14
5	Ratchanok Intanon	74,606	19
6	Putri Kusuma Wardani	71,603	16
7	Tomoka Miyazaki	71,456	20
8	Han Yue	69,008	12
9	Pornpawee Chochuwong	66,927	14
10	Nozomi Okuhara	64,160	17
11	P.V. Sindhu	64,151	12
12	Kim Ga Eun	59,041	15
13	Line Christophersen	57,940	21
14	Michelle Li	55,327	20
15	Mia Blichfeldt	54,483	11

Top Indians



P.V. Sindhu
Rank 11



Unnati Hooda
Rank 24

Test Batting			
#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Harry Brook	861	898
2	Steve Smith	840	947
3	Joe Root	816	932
4	Travis Head	811	884
5	Temba Bavuma	775	806
6	Rachin Ravindra	740	740
7	Rishabh Pant	713	801
8	Daryl Mitchell	710	804
9	Shubman Gill	709	807
10	Kamindu Mendis	706	784

ODI Batting

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Shubman Gill	816	841
2	Virat Kohli	796	908
3	Daryl Mitchell	794	840
4	Rohit Sharma	753	879
5	Ibrahim Zadran	719	756
6	Babar Azam	689	894
7	Kusal Mendis	674	675
8	Shai Hope	673	782
9	Joe Root	660	810
10	Harry Tector	653	730

T20I Batting

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Ishan Kishan	892	910
2	Abhishek Sharma	887	931
3	Sahibzada Farhan	848	848
4	Harry Brook	793	793
5	Jos Buttler	789	794
6	Dewald Brevis	789	806
7	Phil Salt	775	881
8	Pathum Nissanka	757	796
9	Tilak Varma	719	845
10	Mitchell Marsh	706	706

Test Bowling			
#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Mitchell Starc	872	872
2	Matt Henry	861	870
3	Ollie Robinson	856	856
4	Jasprit Bumrah	853	908
5	Pat Cummins	841	914
6	Marco Jansen	825	825
7	Kagiso Rabada	807	902
8	Scott Boland	804	820
9	Josh Hazlewood	783	864
10	Noman Ali	777	853

ODI Bowling

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Rashid Khan	714	775
2	Abrar Ahmed	675	675
3	Keshav Maharaj	667	737
4	Mitchell Santner	644	656
5	Kuldeep Yadav	623	757
6	Maheesh Theekshana	622	680
7	Jofra Archer	617	682
8	Shaheen Afridi	604	691
9	Mehidy Hasan	602	722
10	Josh Hazlewood	591	725

T20I Bowling

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Abrar Ahmed	736	757
2	Rashid Khan	720	828
3	Adam Zampa	700	746
4	Adil Rashid	695	747
5	Nathan Ellis	675	678
6	Jamie Overton	674	674
7	Varun Chakravarthy	665	818
8	Mohammad Nawaz	658	672
9	Wanindu Hasaranga	656	809
10	Liam Dawson	648	652

I can say that my only student is contesting the World title match

Fresh off his success in the Global Chess League, B. Adhiban talks about working as a coach while still being an active player. Having guided Vaishali to Candidates glory, he previews her chances against champion Ju Wenjun. He also reveals why he thinks Gukesh is the favourite against Sindarov and offers an insight into Ganges Grandmasters' triumph in the GCL.



B. VELANKANNI RAJ

INTERVIEW

B. Adhiban

P.K. Ajith Kumar

It was a memorable debut as a coach for B. Adhiban at the Tech Mahindra Global Chess League in Bengaluru last month. He guided Ganges Grandmasters to a maiden title in the world's most glamorous chess league. Nicknamed 'The Beast', he was a part of the Indian teams that won the bronze medal at the Chess Olympiads in 2014 and 2022. Excerpts from an interview Adhiban gave *The Hindu*:

What made you accept the offer to coach Ganges Grandmasters at such short notice?

Manu Gurtu of MGD1 is my manager, and I know the company's Sreekar Channapragada, too. They took over ownership of Ganges Grandmasters and when they offered me the job, I thought it would be interesting. My only condition was that it shouldn't clash with my playing schedule. I joined the team on the eve of the auction. There was one player Manu wanted: Levon Aronian. I also wanted him. Apparently, other teams, too. I was happy that we got him; he is an excellent team player. He can lift the team when it is down.

His sense of humour helps, too...

Yes. And I have liked him as a player for a long time, since the time he won the World junior championship. Another player we really wanted in our team was Nihal Sarin. I am also glad that we got Ian [Nepomniachtchi]. He is a fantastic player. And he gave us that crucial win in the final against Magnus Carlsen [APL Alpine Pipers].

The two women in your team, Polina



If there is one player who could beat Ju Wenjun, I think it is Vaishali. There aren't too many players like Vaishali at the top level in women's chess

Shuvalova and Stavroula Tsolakidou, did a great job. Aronian called them your secret weapon and said he didn't expect them to do so well.

Manu wanted to retain both of them. They had played well last year. Polina, I knew personally that she was a very fast player.

She was brilliant here. She made probably the biggest contribution, overall, to your team...

Yeah, exactly. Because she gave us a very good start, actually. And even when the team was not doing well, she was doing well. Yes, she was someone whom you could always count on. She plays fearlessly; she is not afraid of anyone. In fact, I was expecting that she would win the Player-of-the-Tournament award.

Which went to Stavroula. She thanked you in public, and even handed her Player-of-the-Match award to you on the stage...

That was very touching. Polina already had her own set of ideas. But I did work with Stavi quite a lot, especially in opening preparations. She is an excellent student with an amazing memory. Whatever I suggested during the training, she would replicate on the board. The openings she played here were mostly new for her. We were just improvising during the tournament. We were preparing together every day for at least an hour and a half.

Were there games that went according to the plan more or less?

Well, there was this game with Koneru Humpy in the match against Alpine Pipers. The opening went according to our plan. In the



GCL

final, against Nino [Batsiashvili] too, it was my idea that she implemented over the board.

And Batsiashvili has been mighty good at the GCL.

Yes. I wanted Stavi to beat her, so that she could prove she could beat everyone.

So you must be pleased that you could play a role in the progress of a player.

Yes, because this is what coaching is all about, right?

And this was your first proper stint as a coach, though you worked with R. Vaishali before she played in the Candidates, which she went on to win, much against the odds.

Yes, I could say that my only student is contesting the World championship match.

How do you view Vaishali's chances in that World title match against Ju Wenjun?

She didn't have a good Olympiad at Samarkand. I don't really know what happened. I will talk to her when she comes back. As for the World championship, if there is one player who could beat Ju Wenjun, I think it is Vaishali.

She should play freely, and not worry too much about the result: she shouldn't think, 'What will happen if I don't win'. There aren't too many players like Vaishali at the top level in women's chess, the players who could challenge men, like Judit Polgar or Hou Yifan. Whenever I play against Vaishali, I feel I have to be a bit careful. I don't get that feeling when I meet other female players.

She plays aggressively and fearlessly. She is a bit like Judit in that regard, and rather unlike Hou Yifan. Among the Chinese women, Lei Tingjie, I feel, is the most aggressive player.

Vaishali has to be cautious against Ju Wenjun. She is difficult to beat and not someone who will collapse. I remember the way she [Ju] beat Vidit Gujrathi, someone who resembles her in style. If you can beat a strong player who is very close to your style, it means something.

Talking of World championships, your thoughts on the match between D. Gukesh and Javokhir Sindarov? Not many people are betting on the reigning World champion as he hasn't been in good form after winning the title in 2024.

Well, I believe Gukesh has excellent chances. The way he played at the Olympiad [where he won a silver on the fourth board] should help his confidence. I think the thing is, he should not try to go back to who he was [when he was doing incredible things like winning gold on the top board in successive Olympiads]. He should just find a new version of himself. He has changed a lot and now so many things are different. He has to rediscover himself.

Gukesh is someone who has risen above the expectations. Whatever hurdle you throw at him, he will cross that. A few years back, me and Anish [Giri] had this running joke. When Gukesh was doing so well in classical chess, we would say, 'Okay at least he is bad at rapid chess'. Then he ended up winning some rapid games somewhere. Anish and I now said, 'At least he is still bad at blitz'. Then he won against [Vladimir] Kramnik in Armageddon. Then, after crossing 2700 [Elo points], he came below that. Now we said, 'Maybe he is not 2700 level yet'. Then he comes to the Olympiad and destroys everyone. The moment you think he is done or he is not ready for something, he always proves himself.

Sindarov has been in great form. But when it comes to the peaks of their chess, I feel Gukesh is better than Sindarov. I may be biased, but my favourite for the World title this year is Gukesh.

GAME THEORY

Premier League: goals vs. expected goals

Brighton has generated the most expected goals (xG) and outperformed this metric to lead the Premier League's goal-scoring chart in the opening rounds of the season. Sunderland and Manchester United come in next on xG, but have scored fewer goals than expected, based on the shot opportunities they have had. A look at how the teams in the English top division rank on xG and the margin between the goals they have scored and the xG they have generated (xGDiff):

Rank	Team	xG	Goals	xGDiff
1	Brighton	12.48	14	1.52
2	Sunderland	10.81	6	-4.81
3	Man. United	10.24	7	-3.24
4	Man. City	10.16	13	2.84
5	Brentford	9.84	10	0.16
6	Bournemouth	9.08	5	-4.08
7	Arsenal	8.85	8	-0.85
8	N. Forest	8.76	4	-4.76
9	Chelsea	8.42	10	1.58
10	Liverpool	8.04	7	-1.04
11	Everton	7.74	6	-1.74
12	Fulham	7.74	4	-3.74
13	C. Palace	7.45	5	-2.45
14	Leeds	7.06	6	-1.06
15	Ipswich	6.91	7	0.09
16	Hull	5.97	6	0.03
17	Tottenham	5.91	2	-3.91
18	Newcastle	5.7	9	3.3
19	Coventry	5	1	-4
20	Aston Villa	5	4	-1

SOURCE: WHOSCORED.COM



PASCAL GROSS (BRIGHTON)



BRIAN BROBBEY (SUNDERLAND)



BRUNO FERNANDES (MAN. UNITED)

PICTURE THIS



GETTY IMAGES

Bridge view

The Rolex Big Boat Series, hosted by the historic St. Francis Yacht Club in San Francisco every September, is more than a marquee regatta.

Since its inception six decades ago, it has been viewed as a standard-bearer,

showcasing as it does top talent on the water and boats from around the world. It is also certified as a platinum-level clean regatta since it meets certain sustainability standards.

The event has a unique selling point: the scenic red towers of the Golden Gate Bridge act as a backdrop for

some thrilling finishes.

The St. Francis Yacht Club, founded in 1927, welcomed eight yachts to the edge of the city's Marina district in 1964 for the inaugural Perpetual Trophy Regatta, which in time evolved into the Rolex Big Boat Series.

This year's edition, the 62nd, brought 81 boats and 700

sailors to the pretty venue, doubling as the 2026 ORC North American Championship.

It also featured the returning Classics division, which had boats such as the Ocean Queen V, a 75-year-old wooden yawl that serves as an educational aid for young sailors when it isn't racing.

INCREDIBLE TURNAROUND

Sujeet's Houdini act wins him the top prize in 65kg wrestling



PTI

Sujeet Kalkal underlined his growing supremacy in the men's 65kg category by clinching the Asiad gold, beating an Olympic champion on the way to the title and erasing a massive 2-9 deficit in the final against Tajikistan's Kudiev Abdulmazhid. The Indian wrestler defeated Japan's Olympic champ Kotaro Kiyooka in the semifinal.

FOURTH TIME LUCKY

Nethra Kumanan claims bronze in women's dinghy



REUTERS

Nethra Kumanan clinched the women's dinghy bronze, securing her first podium finish in her fourth Asian Games appearance. The 29-year-old two-time Olympian logged 14 points in all (seven each in the final and qualification) behind winner Sophia Montgomery (5) of Thailand and silver medallist Jania Ang (13) of Singapore.

ON THE PODIUM

Harshita and Shital clinch the third spot in skiff sailing



REUTERS

The Indian duo of Harshita Tomar and Shital Verma won the bronze medal in the women's skiff sailing event at the Asian Games. Harshita and Shital finished the competition with 24 net points and 28 total points across nine races to finish ahead of China, which was disqualified in races two, six and eight. Skiffs are small light boats.

THE PAKISTAN CHALLENGE

Shutting out the outside noise part of professional sport: Kanitkar



PTI

Frankly, there is pressure in every international game. So we need to be in our zone and do our best. Shutting out all the outside noise is part of professional sport. So that's what we'll look to do — Hrishikesh Kanitkar, India's batting coach, on the eve of the Asian Games men's cricket final against Pakistan.

India women baulk Chinese pressure to corner glory

The players end a 44-year wait for gold even as they punch their tickets to the 2028 LA Olympics, following a defensive masterclass led by Savita under the post to protect Lalremsiami's brilliant goal

ASIAN GAMES

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Forty four years. That's how long Indian women's hockey has waited for this moment. Winning the Asian Games, defeating China 1-0 in the final on Friday, was the final box ticked for the year by a group that bears no resemblance to the one that started 2026. The final against the defending champion, a team the Indians have not beaten in the last two years, was never expected to be easy and for many, it would have been downright improbable to think of a victory. The opponent was, after all, also the current Olympic silver medallist. The Gifu Prefectural Green Stadium is, literally,

in the middle of nowhere. There is a grand total of one road leading up to it and India's final hustle for the gold and a spot at the LA Olympics was off to the worst start possible, delayed by an accident en route that forced the match to be pushed back by an hour. Once they reached the ground and play started, though, there was little to suggest the extended wait had any effect on either team. Physically, the Chinese are taller, stronger, more imposing. With the stick and the ball, the Indians were niftier. Most importantly, the attitude screamed. There was none of the pulling back hesitation of old. Sakshi Rana, Lalremsiami and Navneet Kaur were up front and in the Chinese circle at every opportunity. One such moment came



See you in LA! India emerged as the new continental giant and also booked its place in the Summer Games. R.V. MOORTHY

in the 10th minute when Sakshi put the ball through and Lalremsiami, in one fell swoop, reversed the

ball into the net for a 1-0 lead. There would be no change in the scoreline till the final whistle but for the

next 50 minutes, it was a defensive masterclass from Savita & Co. The former captain, under the bar,

proved why there is still no replacement for her even after 15 years of national duty. The Indian defence

Medals table

	Country	G	S	B	T
1	China	162	81	73	316
2	Japan	72	83	85	240
3	South Korea	33	39	62	134
4	Uzbekistan	20	23	22	65
5	India	16	25	35	76

stood tall as everything was blocked, cleared, and tackled with discipline. There were five penalty corners conceded and a stroke too, but nothing worked for China as Shilpi Dabas, Baljeet Singh and Ishika threw themselves at everything. A goalmouth melee resulted in a penalty stroke for China in the 23rd minute but there was no getting past Savita on this day, diving correctly to her left and saving. That moment

changed the momentum, the Indians suddenly believing it was their day. To China's credit, there was no breakdown. Its system held till the very end. But there was only so much a system, as perfect as it may be, could do against a group of women willing to put their bodies on the line and fighting for every inch of and on the turf. Five years ago, another Indian team had held off an Australian side for 38 minutes with a single goal lead. That famous win took India to the Olympic semifinals for the first time ever. Seven from that group were on the pitch on Friday. Along with a younger and bolder bunch, they scripted a memorable triumph. The result (final): China 0 lost to India 1 (Lalremsiami 10).

Lovlina, Parveen and Ankush make it a hat-trick of golds

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Lovlina Borgohain, Parveen Hooda and Ankush Panghal won their respective bouts to clinch three gold and take India to the top of boxing medal tally at the Asian Games here on Friday. Lovlina began the charge with a golden present to herself and the country on her 29th birthday, dominating across all three rounds against China's reigning Asian champion Ziyi Bao in the 75kg for a 5-0 win. Lovlina became only the second Indian woman boxer to win an Asian Games gold, after Mary Kom, but she was not to be the only one at this edition. "There was a time when I thought of giving up boxing but then decided against it. Today it feels surreal to win a gold here. Being compared to a legend like Mary Kom is a motivation and I never thought I would gift myself and the country a gold, this one's very special," Lovlina said. Parveen completed her own redemption arc with a 3-2 victory against Paris Olympic bronze medallist and current Asian champion Chen Nien-chin of Taiwan in the 65kg final. Having won bronze last time around only to see it taken away due to a whe-reabouts clause failure ban, Parveen's gold was a vindication of both her mental and physical tenacity. Ankush's 4-0 triumph over Korea's Kim Minseong in the 80kg capped a fruitful outing for the boxing contingent that finished with three gold and as many bronze.



All that glitters is gold: Lovlina, Parveen and Ankush ensured India's best-ever return from the boxing ring. R.V. MOORTHY & AP

Plucky Indian trio breaks Korea's hegemony in recurve team event

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Kumkum Mohod pulled back the string, stood still and released the arrow. It landed inside the circle for 10 points but while the Indian supporters erupted in joy, the archers themselves were restrained, waiting for an official confirmation. That confirmation not only ended one of the longest Asian Games winning streaks but also etched the names of Kumkum, Kirti and Ankita Bhakat forever in the annals of archery history by winning India's first-ever recurve team gold 5-3 against Korea at the Okazaki Chuo Sogo Park Multipurpose Square here on Friday. This was Korea's first defeat in the event since 1998 as Lee Yunji, Kang Chaeyoung and Oh Yejin came up short in their bid for an eighth straight Asian Games gold. Korea and India scored identical 54 and 56 points each in the first two sets to be tied 2-2. Turning point The third set changed everything. Korea started the set and clearly the pressure got to it. Yunji shot a couple of eights while the other two shot one apiece for Korea to total 51, its lowest all week. In reply, Kirti and Kum-

kum shot a 10 each and an eight and a nine respectively, Ankita had two nines and the team totalled 55 to take the set and lead 4-2. Thereafter, it was only a matter of staying level. In the fourth and final set, Kirti started with an eight but it carried an asterisk, to be confirmed later. Kumkum's final 10 was followed by a closer look by the judges. An eight would take the match into shoot-off; it was adjudicated a nine and it was all over. The gold only burnished the trio's reputation after it had already made history by reaching the final for the first time with a 5-1 victory against China, winning the first two sets easily for a 4-0 lead before sharing points in the third. Minutes later, Kumkum paired up with Dhiraj Bommadevara to come from behind and defeat Japan 5-3 in the semifinals of the mixed event after the host had taken lead in the first set. However, a couple of eights in the second set hurt India's chances in the final against China, having to end with a silver (3-5). Dhiraj also won silver with the men's team of Neeraj Chauhan and Yashdeep Bhoge, going down 1-5 to Korea in the final after a dominant 6-0 victory against Iran in the last four.



Into the record books: Kumkum, Ankita and Kirti on top of the podium after a remarkable show. REUTERS



Overjoyed: Kumkum and Dhiraj celebrate their mixed team silver medal finish. REUTERS



Happy times: Dhiraj, Yashdeep and Neeraj finished with the men's team silver. PTI

THE INDIA SHOW

A look at some Indian performances on Friday:

Archery: Recurve (finals): Women's team: bt South Korea; Men's team: lost to South Korea; Mixed team: lost to China. **Boxing:** Finals: Women: 75kg: Lovlina bt Ziyi (Chn); 65kg:

Parveen bt Nien-chin (Tpe); Men: 80kg: Ankush bt Minseong (Kor). **Golf:** Round 3: Individual: Women: Pranavi (first), Diksha and Aditi (T18); Team: Second; Men: Veer (10th), Saptak (11th), Yuvraj (T23); Team: Sixth. **Hockey:** Women (final): bt China

1-0. **Sailing:** Women's dinghy: Nethra (bronze); Men's dinghy: Vishnu (fourth overall). **Sepaktakraw:** Men's quadrant (semifinal): lost to Japan 0-2, bagged bronze. **Volleyball:** Men (classification

match 5th-8th): bt South Korea 3-1. **Wrestling:** Men's freestyle: 65kg (final): Sujeet bt Abdulmazhid (Tjk); 125kg (1/8 final): Rajat lost to Kassimbek (Kaz); Women: 50kg (bronze medal match): Dipanshi lost to Bayanova (Kaz); 76kg (1/8 final): Priya lost to Kyzy (Kgz).

HI official accused of harassment, sent home

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

On field, the Indian women's hockey team stepped out to create history against China and win the Asian Games for only the second time and the first since 1982. Off it, yet another international embarrassment rocked Indian hockey with Indian umpires manager Gurinder Singh Sangha being sent home following complaints of misbehaviour and harassment. "Yes Sangha has been sent back. There were complaints of him harassing foreign officials officiating here," confirmed a senior official.

INDIANS IN ACTION

A look at some Indian players/teams who will compete on Saturday (all times IST): **Archery:** Recurve individual: Women's quarterfinal: Kumkum vs. Chaeyoung (Kor), 5.30 a.m.; semifinals, 6.30 a.m. onwards; medal matches, 7.05 a.m. onwards; Men's quarterfinal: Dhiraj vs. Sadikov (Uzb), 9.30 a.m.; Neeraj vs. Dorji (Bhu), 10.15 a.m.; semifinals, 10.30 a.m. onwards; medal matches, 11.05 a.m. onwards. **Cricket:** Men (final): vs. Pakistan, 10 a.m. **Hockey:** Men (final): vs. Malaysia, 3.30 p.m. **Volleyball:** Men (classification match 5th-6th): vs. Thailand, 9.30 a.m. **Wrestling:** 1/8 finals: Men's freestyle: 74kg: Sagar vs. Tumur-Ochir (Mgl), 7.20 a.m.; 97kg: Deepak vs. Junpeng (Chn), 7.25 a.m.; 57kg: Aman vs. TBC, 8.25 a.m.; Women: 57kg: Manisha vs. Youngjin (Kor), 7.50 a.m.; 53kg: Antim vs. Shuglya (Kaz), 8.05 a.m.

